



BRICS SUMMIT
12 - 13 September 2026 | New Delhi, India

INDIA 2026
BUILDING FOR RESILIENCE, INNOVATION,
COOPERATION AND SUSTAINABILITY

People-Centric Approach
Spirit of Humanity First



CBC 14:29/13/0011/2627

MODI AND PUTIN MEET ON SCO SIDELINES

‘Move from endless war to end of war’



MPOST BUREAU
Bishkek, August 31

Calling for an immediate end to the Russia-Ukraine conflict, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday urged Russian President Vladimir Putin to move from “endless war to the end of war,” asserting that a peaceful resolution of the conflict is

humanity’s shared priority. In a meeting with Putin on the sidelines of the SCO summit in this capital city of Kyrgyzstan, PM Modi said every day of war sets humanity back and that India, the land of Gandhi and Buddha, supports all efforts towards peace and will continue to do so. The two leaders also exten-

CLOSER LOOK

- » India backs all efforts toward peaceful resolution
- » Modi calls peaceful resolution humanity’s shared priority
- » PM invokes Gandhi and Buddha’s message of peace
- » Modi urges diplomacy and dialogue to resolve conflict
- » India will continue supporting peace efforts
- » PM says every war day sets humanity back
- » Leaders discuss trade and investment cooperation

» ENERGY SECURITY FEATURES PROMINENTLY IN BILATERAL DISCUSSIONS

Modi, Pezeshkian discuss trade, regional peace and shipping safety



MPOST BUREAU
Bishkek, August 31

Prime Minister Narendra Modi conveyed to Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on Monday that India wants to “expand and diversify” the trade basket with Iran in the “times to come” and called for resolution of the West Asia conflict through dialogue and diplomacy. Modi held talks with Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the SCO summit in this capital city of Kyrgyzstan. “Met President Masoud Pezeshkian in Bishkek. Reiterated our commitment to strengthening India’s long-standing

CONTINUED ON P4

Delhi draft voter roll drops 47.56 lakh names

Nearly one-third names missing, voters get month to seek inclusion

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 31

Delhi’s electoral map has undergone a major shake-up, with nearly one in every three names on the existing voter list failing to make it to the draft electoral roll released on Monday following the first phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR). As many as 47,56,722 names are missing from the draft list, accounting for nearly 33 per cent of the 1,45,10,299 electors on the roll when the exercise began, although the Election Commission has clarified that the omission is not necessarily final. The SIR began on June 30 with 1,45,10,299 electors. During the house-to-house enumeration, Booth Level Officers (BLOs) distributed forms to all voters and by August 17 had received and digitised forms from 97,53,577 elec-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Draft roll retains 97.53 lakh electors
- » SIR began with 1.45 crore Delhi electors
- » BLOs digitised forms from 67.22% electors
- » Over 43.32 lakh marked shifted, absent or others
- » Draft excludes 2.82 lakh deceased electors
- » Multiple enrolments removed for 1.41 lakh electors
- » Eligible voters can seek inclusion through Form 6
- » Claims and objections open until September 30

tors, or 67.22 per cent. The 47,56,722 excluded names comprise 43,32,775 electors classified as permanently shifted, absent or under “Others”, 2,82,412 deceased and 1,41,535 found enrolled at multiple places. Officials said the first

CONTINUED ON P4

Q1 GDP growth beats estimates at 7.8% despite global uncertainty

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 31

India’s economy grew 7.8 per cent in the April-June quarter of 2026-27, beating expectations and the Reserve Bank of India’s 7 per cent forecast despite global uncertainty, oil price shocks and supply chain disruptions linked to the Iran conflict. The latest data released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) on Monday showed that growth remained strong, although it slowed from 8.6 per cent in the previous quarter. The economy had expanded 6.9 per cent in the April-June quarter of 2025-26. Real GDP at constant prices was estimated at Rs 81.36 lakh crore in the first quarter of

CONTINUED ON P4

India rejects Hague Court’s Indus Waters Treaty ruling

New Delhi, August 31

India on Monday rejected a ruling by the Hague-based Permanent Court of Arbitration calling for the Indus Waters Treaty to remain in force, saying the body has no authority over New Delhi’s sovereign decisions.

The Ministry of External Affairs said India does not recognise the tribunal, which it described as having been constituted in violation of the 1960 treaty. “This so-called Court of Arbitration

CONTINUED ON P4

SC declines to stop CJP’s Sept 5 march

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 31

The Supreme Court on Monday declined to intervene against a protest march proposed by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) in Delhi on September 5, observing that there was currently no basis to presume that the demonstration would lead to any untoward incident.

A three-judge bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, along with Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, was hearing a plea filed by retired Delhi Police officer Rajendra Singh challenging the proposed march. The petitioner argued that large-scale demonstrations

SC to hear today Delhi Police plea to quash 13 FIRs

New Delhi, August 31

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to hear a Delhi Police plea seeking to withdraw 13 FIRs linked to protests over the NEET paper leak and register a fresh case against 2,873 people allegedly present at the demonstrations.

CONTINUED ON P4

in sensitive parts of the national capital should not be permitted

CONTINUED ON P4

UP teen gang-raped on moving bus in Noida; two arrested

Dumped 43-47 km away in Kashmere Gate

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 31

A 16-year-old Class 11 student was allegedly gang-raped inside an empty sleeper bus after she boarded it at Greater Noida’s Pari Chowk on the night of August 4, believing its driver and conductor would take her to Noida Sector 63. The two men allegedly assaulted her while the bus was moving and later abandoned her near Kashmere Gate in north Delhi, police said. The accused, identified as driver Kuldeep, 39, and conductor Sandeep, 26, were arrested from a



The suspected sleeper bus after a 16-year-old Class 11 student was allegedly gang-raped inside it

PTI

bus parking lot in Timarpur with the help of CCTV footage. The girl, a resident of Mainpuri in Uttar Pradesh, had left home after a quarrel with her mother and was travelling to Sector 63 to stay with her cousin. She told police that she mistak-

THE GIRL, A RESIDENT OF MAINPURI IN UTTAR PRADESH, HAD LEFT HOME AFTER A QUARREL WITH HER MOTHER AND WAS TRAVELLING TO SECTOR 63 TO STAY WITH HER COUSIN

only got off at Pari Chowk at around 9 pm amid heavy rain and found herself about 25 km from her destination. As she looked for transport, the sleeper bus stopped near her. Police said Kuldeep and Sandeep told her

CONTINUED ON P4

Blast at firecracker factory kills 11 in UP’s Kaushambi



People gather after a massive explosion

PTI

MPOST BUREAU
Kaushambi (UP), August 31

Eleven people were killed and five others seriously injured after a powerful explosion at a firecracker factory in Manori village of Uttar Pradesh’s Kaushambi district on Monday afternoon, officials said.

The injured are undergoing treatment at SRN Hospital in Prayagraj.

District Magistrate Amit Pal said 11 people initially injured in the blast were taken to the hospital, where they later died during treatment. The deceased were identified as Priyanjali,

CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

Girl dies after being made to stand in sun

NEW DELHI: A 10-year-old girl died during treatment after allegedly being made to stand in the sun as punishment for not bringing a book to her Delhi government school in East Vinod Nagar on August 27. The government transferred the teacher pending an inquiry. Education Minister Ashish Sood said strict action would follow if negligence is established.

SEE P2

Govt flags porn ads, Android apps in fraud

NEW DELHI: The National Cybercrime Threat Analytics Unit (NCTAU) has cautioned Android users against financial fraud through malicious applications promoted via Facebook and Instagram ads.

CONTINUED ON P4



MESSI TO KEEP PLAYING FOR MIAMI

Messi says adios

Argentina star Lionel Messi retires from international football with World Cup title and 125 goals

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Buenos Aires, August 31

Argentina superstar Lionel Messi announced his retirement from international football on Monday, ending 21 years of national-team duty that were capped by winning the World Cup in 2022 to secure his place in the pantheon of the game’s greatest ever players.

“It was a decision that hurt – and still hurts deeply – but I understand that the time has come,” the 39-year-old Messi said on his Instagram account.

Messi, who will continue to play at club level with Inter Miami in Major League Football, played in a record-tying six World Cups. He won it four years ago in a tournament he dominated in Qatar and also led Argentina to the title match in 2014 and again this year,

CLOSER LOOK

- » His international career included 2022 World Cup glory
- » Messi is 39 years old
- » Messi played a record-tying six World Cups
- » Argentina reached three World Cup finals with Messi
- » Argentina lost 2026 final to Spain
- » Messi played 207 games for Argentina
- » He finishes with Argentina-record 125 international goals
- » Messi scored 21 goals across World Cup tournaments

when the Albiceleste lost to Spain in extra time in New Jersey.

Messi stands shoulder to shoulder with Diego Maradona, a compatriot with whom he

CONTINUED ON P4

At least 900 hydropower workers remain unreachable

Toll surges to 939 in Nepal; 4,247 still missing

MPOST BUREAU
Battar (Nepal), August 31

The death toll from the devastating flash floods that struck Nepal on August 26 rose to 939 on Monday, while 4,247 people remained missing as rescue teams continued searching through flooded settlements, damaged roads and hydropower tunnels. More than 10,000 people have been rescued so far, including hundreds evacuated from hydropower projects, but intermittent rain, swollen rivers and destroyed infrastructure are slowing efforts to reach those still stranded. At least 933 workers and employees at flood-hit hydropower sites have been out of contact since the disaster, with

KEY POINTS

- » More than 10,000 people have been rescued
- » Rescuers face swollen rivers and damaged roads
- » Floods devastated northern and central Nepal
- » Bhotekoshi River carried floodwaters downstream
- » Homes, vehicles, roads and bridges were swept away

more than 600 believed to be trapped inside tunnels, according to the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA).

The floods, believed to have been triggered by a collapse or avalanche of ice and rock near the Nepal-Tibet border,

India witnessed hottest August since 1901: IMD

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 31

India is likely to receive below-normal rainfall in September, with monthly precipitation expected to remain below 91 per cent of the long-period average (LPA), the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Monday. The forecast comes after the country recorded its hottest August since records began in 1901.

The LPA for September is 167.9 mm, based on rainfall data from 1971 to 2020. The IMD also forecast that the average maximum temperature during September is likely to remain above normal.

IMD Director General of Meteorology Mrutyunjay Mohapatra attributed the outlook partly to strong El Nino

CONTINUED ON P4

CHILD TIED TO CHAIR, ASSAULTED

CM orders action, playschool sealed

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 31

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday ordered strict action against a private playschool in Maujpur after a three-year-old child was allegedly tied to a chair and physically assaulted, with the premises subsequently sealed over multiple safety and building violations.

The Chief Minister's Office said Gupta had taken "serious cognisance" of the "deeply disturbing" incident at Makoons Kids Unplugged pre-school and daycare activity centre in Jammu Mohalla, Maujpur. "Delhi Government will ensure that responsibility is fixed and those found guilty face the strictest action under law," the CMO said.

An attendant has been arrested in connection with the assault, while a teacher, school principal and director have been booked. Police are investigating the case.

An inspection by the Sub-Divisional Magistrate (Yamuna Vihar) found several violations at the premises. The playschool did not have a fire safety certificate, sanctioned building plan or completion/occupancy certificate. Inspectors also found the emergency exit and staircases blocked, while the only fire extinguisher was non-functional.

The inspection report



CLOSER LOOK

- » Inspection by the Sub-Divisional Magistrate (Yamuna Vihar) found several violations at the premises
- » The playschool did not have a fire safety certificate, sanctioned building plan or completion/occupancy certificate
- » An attendant has been arrested in connection with the assault, while a teacher, school principal and director have been booked. Police are investigating the case
- » Inspectors also found the emergency exit and staircases blocked, while the only fire extinguisher was non-functional

further stated that a borewell had been installed without permission and that the rooms lacked proper ventilation. Classes were allegedly being conducted in the basement in violation of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, 1957. The school was also operating commercial activity in a residential area and running a kitchen with domestic LPG cylinders.

After the school management failed to produce satisfactory replies or required permissions,

the premises were sealed "to ensure public safety", the SDM said.

Gupta said inhumane treatment of children would not be tolerated and accountability would extend to school management wherever negligence is found.

Meanwhile, Education Minister Ashish Sood said an inquiry was underway into the death of a student at a school in East Vinod Nagar. The concerned teacher has been transferred pending the inquiry.

Delhi partners firms to beautify flyover, road spaces

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 31

Delhi government on Monday signed MoUs with two private companies to transform neglected and underutilised spaces beneath flyovers and along major roads into clean, green and safer public spaces under the public-private partnership (PPP) model.

The agreements were signed by the Public Works Department (PWD) in the presence of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh. The initiative will focus on cleanliness, greenery, beautification, pedestrian movement, safety and environmental awareness.



As part of the initiative, Dixon Technologies and Vrikshit Foundation will develop a 2.5-km stretch from Deepali to Mangolpuri Market beneath the flyover. The project will include fencing along the stretch, organised landscaping and greenery using local plant species, grass, shrubs and flowering plants. Environment-

themed and clean-energy mural art will also be created on 61 flyover pillars, covering around 5,100 square metres.

Separately, the Kanodia Group will develop and maintain around two acres of green belt along Mathura Road and MP Road through its CSR initiative. The area, currently affected by garbage

dumping, encroachments and unplanned use, will be developed with trees, shrubs, flowering plants, walkways, lighting and landscaped public spaces.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said, "Building a clean, green and beautiful Delhi is a collective responsibility of the government, society and the private sector." She said the government was encouraging PPPs to transform neglected spaces into "better, safer, attractive and environment-friendly public spaces" and improve citizens' quality of life through better utilisation of existing urban spaces.

She added that the projects would improve the appearance and iden-

tity of major corridors, increase greenery and promote cleanliness, while private-sector participation through CSR would strengthen long-term maintenance.

Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the government was working to make Delhi "clean and beautiful" in line with the Chief Minister's vision. He said the CM had directed from the beginning that areas around flyovers and along roads should be properly beautified and developed.

He thanked the partner organisations for taking responsibility for the projects and said such initiatives would be encouraged as a positive example of public participation.

L-G reviews traffic plans ahead of BRICS

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, August 31

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Monday reviewed the functioning of the Delhi Traffic Police and directed its senior leadership to work closely with all concerned agencies to ensure smoother traffic movement, stricter enforcement of road discipline and proactive management of congestion hotspots.

The L-G visited the Delhi Traffic Police Headquarters in Todapur and interacted with senior officers on traffic congestion, road safety and measures to address traffic-related problems. He stressed the need for greater citizen participation and seamless inter-agency coordination to build safer roads, improve traffic manage-



ment and enhance public confidence.

Sandhu underlined that a coordinated, technology-enabled and citizen-centric approach was essential for a safer and better-managed Delhi. He directed the senior traffic leadership to work closely with all relevant agencies towards these objectives.

During the visit, Sandhu was briefed on various initiatives being implemented

by the Delhi Traffic Police to improve traffic management. These included Traffic Pathshala, which aims to sensitise traffic violators; Traffic Panchayat, which brings civic agencies and other stakeholders together to address traffic management issues; and special enforcement drives against dangerous traffic violations.

The L-G was also briefed on traffic arrangements

being planned for the forthcoming BRICS Summit in Delhi, which will be attended by Heads of State and Government, dignitaries and senior delegates from foreign countries.

He was informed that the Delhi Traffic Police was making foolproof, technology-driven arrangements to ensure the safe and seamless movement of foreign Heads and dignitaries, as well as the Prime Minister and other Ministers, while minimising inconvenience to the general public.

Special Commissioner of Police/Traffic Ajay Chaudhry, Joint Commissioner of Police/Traffic Sanjay Tyagi, three Additional Commissioners of Police/Traffic, along with DCPs/Traffic and two ACPs/Traffic, were present during the visit.

CBI unearths Rs 28.87-cr rice scam in Capital

New Delhi, August 31

The CBI has unearthed an alleged rice scam in Delhi involving two Assam-based firms and a Kolkata-based company, which allegedly procured 50,645 metric tonnes of rice through the North Eastern Regional Agricultural Marketing Corporation Ltd (NERAMAC) from the Food Corporation of India (FCI) and sold it in private markets for wrongful gains of Rs 28.87 crore.

The CBI said the rice was meant to be supplied at affordable rates to daily wage earners, labourers, migrant workers and others not covered under the Public Distribution System due to the absence of

ration cards. The alleged irregularities took place between January and May 2026. The agency said NERAMAC was not eligible to receive rice from FCI without participating in an e-auction, as such allocations were permitted only to state governments.

The CBI alleged that NERAMAC officials, in connivance with the three firms, approached the Delhi Food and Civil Supplies Minister on January 7 seeking allocation without e-auction.

Delhi government forwarded the proposal to FCI on April 8; it approved the allocation the same day, enabling firms to procure cheaper rice. MPOST

City to set up medical rooms in 100 schools on pilot basis

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 31

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday said the Delhi government will set up dedicated medical rooms in 100 government schools on a pilot basis to provide students immediate first aid, basic health support and counselling.

The initiative will subsequently be expanded in phases to 1,086 government schools based on the outcome and evaluation of the pilot project, according to a statement issued by the Chief Minister's Office.

An allocation of Rs 5 crore has been made in this year's Budget Esti-

MEDICAL ROOMS WILL PROVIDE FIRST AID, TEMPORARY REST, BASIC HEALTH SUPPORT...

mates for implementing the pilot project. Additional funds required for the expansion will be provided in the coming years based on the pilot's evaluation and outcomes, it stated. The medical rooms will provide first aid, temporary rest, basic health support, age-appropriate health guidance and counselling to students when required, it said.

The facilities will also provide girl students with a

safe and private space during menstrual discomfort. "Our aim is to provide students immediate first aid, basic health support and counselling when needed," Gupta said.

Trained health workers will be engaged through an approved outsourcing arrangement to provide primary health support at the medical rooms. They will also assist with counselling, health-awareness activities and maintenance of relevant records, according to the statement.

Government to use existing school infrastructure to create safe, inclusive and health-supportive learning environments.

Govt removes land-area bar for private school upgrades

New Delhi, August 31

The Delhi government removed the fixed minimum land-area requirement for granting fresh recognition, extending recognition and upgrading unaided private schools in the national capital, according to an order issued by the Directorate of Education.

The decision, approved by Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, supersedes the Directorate's 2014 circular to the extent that it prescribed fixed minimum land-area norms for recognition or upgradation of private

schools. Under the new norms, the Directorate of Education will not prescribe any fixed minimum land area as a condition for granting fresh recognition, extending recognition or upgrading private schools in Delhi.

Schools must meet minimum land requirements prescribed by their affiliating boards, while recognition remains subject to applicable education laws. The Directorate clarified that recognition does not constitute affiliation or exemption from norms prescribed by boards or other statutory authorities. MPOST

'Dengue cases fall 46%'

ANANTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 31

With Delhi's dengue cases showing a decline, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has intensified surveillance and mosquito-control measures across the city, with Mayor Pravesh Wahi directing officials to maintain weekly reviews of vector-borne diseases.

At a review meeting on Monday, officials said 311 dengue cases had been recorded in Delhi up to August 31, against 499 during the corresponding period last year a 46 per cent decline.

The MCD Public Health Department has so far carried out fogging and insecticide spraying at 1,197 locations. The Mayor directed officials to undertake targeted spraying at construction sites, religious places, parks, schools and health centres, besides acting promptly



at potential mosquito-breeding sites.

Wahi asked field staff to step up monitoring and work in coordination with elected representatives to strengthen prevention efforts. Officials from the Public Health Department, including the Municipal Health Officer and Deputy Health Officers from all 12 zones, attended the meeting.

Mayor said the MCD would adopt a multi-level strategy to contain vector-borne diseases, with weekly reviews and public cooperation to prevent water stagnation and mosquito breeding ahead of the peak season.

CLAIMS WINDOW OPENS ON AUG 31; REMAINS OPEN TILL SEPT 30

SIR draft out: How to check name, file claim & understand exclusions

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 31

Delhi's draft electoral roll under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) was published on Monday, excluding 47,56,722 of the 1,45,10,299 existing electors.

A claims and objections window will remain open from August 31 to September 30, with the final roll scheduled for November 4.

How can voters check their names?

Voters can search the draft roll through the Delhi CEO or Election Commission electoral search portal using their EPIC number or registered mobile number.



What if a name is missing?

Eligible voters can seek inclusion by submitting Form 6, along with the prescribed Declaration form and supporting documents, between August 31 and September 30. Those who have permanently shifted can submit Form 6 at their new residence.

Why are 47.5 lakh electors missing?

Of the existing electors, completed enumeration forms for more than 67 per cent were digitised. The remaining 47,56,722 were categorised as Absent, Shifted, Dead, Duplicate and Others (ASDDO), with most marked as permanently shifted. Their exclusion from the draft does

ELIGIBLE VOTERS CAN SEEK INCLUSION BY SUBMITTING FORM 6, ALONG WITH THE PRESCRIBED DECLARATION FORM, SUPPORTING DOCUS

not prevent eligible voters from seeking inclusion.

What is Form 6?

Form 6 is used to seek inclusion in the electoral roll. Applicants must provide proof of date of birth and residence. Accepted documents include Aadhaar, birth certificate, PAN card, driving licence, Class X/XII certificate or

passport. Residence proof includes utility bills, Aadhaar, bank/post-office passbook, passport, land records, registered rent deed or sale deed.

How can Form 6 be submitted?

Forms can be filed online through the Voters' Services Portal or ECINET app, or offline through the AERO, ERO or BLO.

Why is SIR being conducted?

The house-to-house exercise verifies voter details and removes errors and ineligible entries. Enumeration ran from June 30 to August 17. Claims will be examined until October 29.

Women to get e-auto permits

NEWDELHI:Delhiplans to launch the DURGA scheme, issuing 1,300 e-auto permits, including 1,170 for women and 130 for transgender persons. Applicants aged 20-40 with annual family income below Rs 5 lakh will be eligible. Beneficiaries will receive Letters of Intent and may be selected through a draw of lots. The scheme also proposes aggregator partnerships, dedicated parking and charging points, safety measures and EV incentives, including Rs 50,000 purchase support.

From page 1

‘Move from

Modi said in his televised opening remarks at the meeting.

“Every day of war sets human-ity back, whereas every step taken towards peace fills humanity with new hope and enthusiasm. We must move away from endless war towards an end to the war,” he said.

“This is crucial for the well-being of humanity. A peaceful resolution to all issues at the earliest is the call of humanity, and this is India’s mes-sage. The land of Gandhi and Buddha shares a single message: the path of peace,” Modi said.

The bilateral with President Putin came a week before he is expected to visit New Delhi to attend the BRICS summit.

PM Modi’s comment reinforces his “not the era of war” comment made in 2022 during his meeting with President Putin – again, on the sidelines of the SCO meet – had re-sonated across the world at the time. The last time Modi and Putin met was in December 2025 when the Russian President visited India on a two-day state visit for the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit.

In dialogues with Putin and Ukraine’s President Volodimir Zel-ensky, India has consistently under-scored the need for dialogue to resolve the conflict.

“India is an advocate of perma-nent peace in this region. Our stand is very clear – this is not an era of war. This is the time to come together against those challenges which threaten humanity. Therefore, India believes in diplomacy and di-alogues,” PM Modi had said in 2022.

“Focusing on national interest as the paramount priority has been our shared approach, and this will remain our guiding principle in the future as well.”

Putin, for his part, said Russia-India relations have witnessed an upswing based on the special and privileged partnership. He hailed Modi’s efforts towards bringing the two countries together and for pay-ing special attention to the relations of India and Russia.

Modi, Pezeshkian

friendship with Iran across diverse sectors,” Modi said on social media.

“We want to expand and diversify our trade basket in the times to come. We had a discussion on the prevail-ing situation in the region. India will continue to support all efforts aimed at ensuring lasting peace,” he said.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said the two leaders discussed the West Asia conflict and shared per-spectives on the evolving situation.

“The prime minister expressed concern at the escalation of tensions in the region and reiterated India’s consistent position that all issues must be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy,” it said.

The two leaders met days after the US warned that economic engage-ment “of any kind” with Iran could trigger penalties as the Trump administration seeks to isolate Teh-ran financially.

Against that backdrop, PM Modi and Pezeshkian discussed ways to expand and diversify the India-Iran trade basket, while also taking up the evolving situation in West Asia and the safety of commercial ship-ping and seafarers.

Modi also reiterated the need for continued efforts to ensure lasting peace and stability in the region.

“Calling for safeguarding the free-dom of navigation and commerce, he emphasised that civilians and civilian infrastructure, including commercial shipping and seafarers must not be harmed under any circumstances,” the MEA said.

“Reiterating India’s readiness to closely cooperate with Iran in mul-tilateral organisations, including BRICS and SCO, the prime minister conveyed that he looked forward to welcoming President Pezeshkian to India for the BRICS Summit,” it said in a statement.

An Iranian readout of the Modi-Pezeshkian meeting said the Iran president expressed “appreciation” for New Delhi’s support and coopera-tion with Iran during the recent war and emphasised the need to intensify diplomatic efforts to establish peace and security in the region.

“From the very beginning of our administration, our efforts have been focused on ensuring peace and security and resolving issues through dialogue and negotiations,” Pezeshkian said.

“Unfortunately, instead of mak-ing use of diplomatic mechanisms,

the Americans have chosen the path of war, insecurity and imposing their will through force,” he said, accord-ing to the readout.

Pezeshkian added: “Our responsi-bility requires us to protect our peo-ple from danger and insecurity and to create the conditions necessary for them to achieve peace, tranquil-ity and security.”

Delhi draft voter

category includes people who moved to another state/UT, could not be located, failed to submit forms by the deadline or did not wish to remain enrolled.

An official said eligible voters still have an opportunity to return to the roll: “People who believe they are eligible can apply through Form 6. They still have time.”

Claims and objections can be filed from August 31 to September 30. Form 6, with the prescribed declara-tion and supporting documents, can be submitted through BLOs, EROs and AEROs or online via the Elec-tion Commission’s voter services por-tal and ECINET app. Form 6A is for overseas Indian electors, Form 7 for objections/deletion and Form 8 for shifting residence, corrections, EPIC replacement and PwD marking.

The CEO’s office said deletion can-not be arbitrary: the ERO/AERO must issue notice, conduct an inquiry and give the elector an opportunity to be heard before passing a speaking order.

The draft has 49,88,993 male, 47,64,137 female and 447 third-gen-der electors, including 1,03,870 aged 18-19, 40,871 aged 85-plus and 189 aged over 100.

Rohini recorded the highest digiti-sation rate at 83.43 per cent and Tughlakabad the lowest at 52.15 per cent. Matiala has the largest elector-ate at 3,33,057, while Delhi Cantt has the smallest at 41,654.

Polling-station rationalisation reduced the voter ceiling from 1,500 to 1,200 per station, raising polling stations from 13,033 to 14,947 and locations from 2,696 to 2,856.

The exercise involved 13,033 BLOs. Political parties appointed 33,226 Booth Level Agents: BJP 12,788, Congress 10,772, AAP 9,462, BSP 128 and CPI(M) 76, up from 17,626 at the start.

AAP convenor Arvind Kejriwal criticised the scale of exclusions, say-ing such an exercise, if replicated nationally, could drastically reduce the effective voter population.

The CEO’s office said SIR is aimed at ensuring eligible citizens are retained while deceased, shifted and duplicate entries are identified. Booth-wise exclusion lists have been displayed at ERO/AERO offices and polling stations and uploaded online.

The notice and disposal process will continue till October 29, with the final electoral roll due on November 4. Citizens turning 18 on or before October 1, 2026, have also been encouraged to apply through Form 6. Helpdesks, the 1950 helpline, IT support, grievance cells and aware-ness campaigns have been deployed to assist voters.

Q1 GDP growth

FY27, compared with Rs 75.46 lakh crore in the same period a year earlier. Nominal GDP at current prices rose 10.3 per cent to Rs 88.27 lakh crore from Rs 80 lakh crore a year ago.

The stronger-than-expected growth comes amid concerns that the Iran conflict and disruptions in energy markets could push up oil prices, fuel inflation and weaken global demand. The RBI has pro-jected India’s overall GDP growth at 6.7 per cent for FY27.

“Indian economy has sustained growth momentum despite global headwinds,” MoSPI said.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi welcomed the figures, calling the first-quarter performance a “hercu-lean feat”. In a post on X, he said India had delivered the growth despite “oil price shocks and sup-ply chain issues” amid global uncer-tainty. “Doomsayers were doomed and India bloomed...yet again!” he said.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sithara-man attributed the performance to economic reforms and management of the economy. “The credit for this strong performance goes to the peo-ple of India and their hard work,” she said in a post on X.

Blast at firecracker

5, Praveen Singh, 13, Jahanvi, 12, Aditya, 12, Aditya, 8, Ravi, 8, Anju, 32, Gyan Singh, 40, Vikram Saroj, 35, Ansh, 6, and Nana, 4.

Officials said all those killed lived

near the factory. More than 18 people are suspected to have been injured in the explosion, raising concerns that the death toll could increase.

The blast, near the Manori power house, destroyed the factory and damaged surrounding structures. Five to six houses next to the facility also collapsed. Rescue teams were using excavators and 10 bulldozers to clear the debris as police searched for people who may still be trapped.

The explosion also damaged a high-voltage electricity pole and power lines. Electricity department workers were repairing the network to restore supply.

The blast affected rail traffic on the nearby Delhi-Howrah route, which was suspended for about an hour. The Ajmer-Sealdah Express was sent back to Manori station, while the Delhi-Varanasi Vande Bharat Express was halted at Saiyad Sarawan station.

More than a dozen fire tenders, around two dozen ambulances and over 50 Air Force personnel joined NDRF, SDRF, police and fire brigade teams at the site. The blaze was brought under control before res-cue work began.

District Magistrate Pal, Superin-tendent of Police Satyanarayan Pra-japat and Prayagraj Range Inspector General Ajay Mishra visited the site. Manori Air Force Station is about two kilometres away.

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath consoled the deaths and announced Rs 2 lakh for each deceased per-son’s family and Rs 50,000 for each injured person. He directed officials to ensure medical care and assis-tance for affected families.

UP teen gang-raped

they were going towards Sector 63 and offered her a lift. She boarded the vehicle, which was not operat-ing as a passenger service that night.

According to investigators, the bus had developed a technical prob-lem and had been taken to a work-shop in Surajpur, Greater Noida, for repairs. The two accused report-edly collected it from the workshop around 5 pm and began travelling towards Delhi later in the evening. They allegedly picked up the girl at Pari Chowk and continued towards Kashmere Gate.

The girl alleged that inappropriate advances were made soon after she boarded the bus and that both men raped her when she resisted, threatening to kill her. Police said the bus travelled around 43 to 47 km before the girl was abandoned on Ring Road near Kashmere Gate ISBT. She then took an auto-rickshaw to the Kashmere Gate police station and reported the incident.

DCP (North) Niharika Bhatt said police acted without getting into jurisdictional issues. “Police got the victim medically examined, which confirmed rape, and registered a case,” she said. The girl was later produced before the Child Welfare Committee and handed over to her father on its directions.

CCTV footage from locations along the route helped police trace the bus within a few hours. Both accused, who are residents of Kan-pur, were subsequently arrested from Timarpur. Police have seized the bus, conducted potency tests on the accused and sent the vehicle for forensic examination.

Investigators said strands of the girl’s hair were found inside the bus. Further forensic examination is underway. The bus reportedly had company-fitted curtains around its sleeper berths, while its CCTV sys-tem was not operational because the vehicle was under renovation. Monu, manager of Vishwanath Travels, said the bus was being taken to Kashmere Gate for painting after repair work. “We didn’t know what happened that day... We learned through police afterwards,” he said, adding that the company was cooperating with investigators.

Police are examining CCTV foot-age and other evidence to reconstruct the bus’s movement and determine whether it stopped along the route. They are also checking the accused’s criminal records and whether their backgrounds were properly verified before they were hired. The two men had reportedly been working with Vishwanath Travels for more than two years.

SC declines

without the requisite police clear-ances. The plea assumes significance as the BRICS Summit is scheduled in Delhi on September 12 and 13, with the petitioner expressing concern over an international gathering coin-ciding with a potentially disruptive protest.

Appearing for Singh, advocate Dr

Rizwan Ahmed said, “On 12th and 13th, international dignitaries are coming to the capital,” and urged the court to defer the CJP march until September 15.

The Bench, however, said it had no reason at this stage to antici-pate violence or disorder. “There are no compelling circumstances for us to presume that anything wrong would happen. Everybody will con-duct themselves in a peaceful, law-ful and reasonable manner,” CJI Kant observed.

SC to hear today

A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana took up the matter after Solicitor General Tushar Mehta sought an urgent hear-ing. Mehta said the police wanted to move an interlocutory applica-tion invoking Article 142 of the Constitution.

According to the application, the Centre’s July 25 decision led Delhi Police to stop pursuing the 13 FIRs related to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protests. However, police said 2,873 people present at the protest site were prima facie found to have serious criminal antecedents in the National Crime Records Bureau data-base. It sought permission to file a fresh FIR limited to these individuals to investigate possible involvement in offences involving bodily harm or property damage.

The police said no new FIR would cover incidents already included in the existing cases.

The plea comes ahead of a CJP protest march planned for Teachers’ Day, led by families of students who died by suicide following the NEET controversy and people alleging police excesses during the agitation.

The Supreme Court had ear-lier appointed a committee headed by former judge Justice R Subhash Reddy to examine allegations of police excesses.

On August 3, the court clarified that “criminal antecedents” referred only to involvement in grave and heinous offences. The 36-day agi-tation, which began on June 20, was withdrawn on July 25 after the then education minister Dharmen-dra Pradhan resigned and the gov-ernment accepted the group’s other demands.

India rejects Hague

has no jurisdiction whatsoever to pronounce on India’s sovereign deci-sions,” it said.

The treaty, signed in Septem-ber 1960, governs the sharing of the Indus River system between India and Pakistan. India suspended the agreement after the April 22, 2025, Pahalgam terror attack, which killed 26 people. New Delhi has said the suspension will continue until Paki-stan takes verifiable and irreversible action against cross-border terror networks.

The arbitration proceedings stem from Pakistan’s objections to the design of India’s Kishenganga and Ratle hydroelectric projects on the western rivers. India has opposed the process from the outset, arguing that such technical disputes should be handled by a neutral expert under the treaty.

India said it has never appeared before the tribunal and rejected its earlier pronouncements. It said the latest and any future rulings by the body would have “no effect” on its actions concerning the projects.

Govt flags porn ads

In an advisory issued on August 26, the NCTAU, part of the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C), said apps hosting porno-graphic content are being promoted through social media ads that direct users to external APK links.

According to the advisory, users clicking on such ads are redirected to websites hosting pornographic con-tent and then tricked into download-ing APK files from unverified sources instead of the Google Play Store.

“Malware apps, when installed, can ask for Accessibility permis-sions,” the advisory said, adding that this can give attackers extensive con-trol over the device. Such apps can operate in the background, install additional applications disguised as updates and, in some cases, install a VPN to route data through attacker-controlled servers.

Messi says adios

was so often compared, and Bra-zil icon Pelé as the greatest players of all time.

For many, he’s the best. “I swear to you that I always gave

it my all – not just in these last few years when we won everything, but before that too,” Messi wrote.

“I always fought and left every-thing on the field for this jersey, to bring you joy and make you feel proud to be Argentine through football.”

Messi played 207 games for Argen-tina and finishes as its all-time lead-ing scorer with 125 goals, 21 of them in World Cups. Only one player has more goals in men’s internationals – his long-time rival Cristiano Ronaldo, who has 146 and has yet to announce his retirement from Portugal duty.

Messi became the all-time lead-ing World Cup scorer for a month in the recent tournament in the U.S., Mexico and Canada, but finished one goal behind France’s Kylian Mbappé.

In a long social-media post, Messi explained he wrote his retirement letter on July 21 – two days after the World Cup final in which he strug-gled to make an impact – but waited to publish it because his father was facing health issues that eventually claimed his life.

Jorge Messi died on Aug. 8 in his native Rosario.

Two months after Messi starred at the 2005 world under-20 cham-pionship, scoring both of Argen-tina’s goals in the final triumph and being named the best player, he was given his senior Argentina debut at 18. His first appearance lasted only two minutes; the substitute was sent off against Hungary in Budapest.

His journey with the national team was fraught with more frustra-tion – he briefly retired from Argen-tina duty in 2016 after three defeats in three consecutive major finals – until he finally lifted the World Cup four years ago, either side of also winning Copa America titles in 2021 and ‘24.

“Thank you for all the love these past 20 years,” he said. “I’m going to miss hearing you all from the inside so much. Now I’m going to be one of you, cheering and supporting you from the outside (through thick and thin, even more so).”

In the letter, Messi did not say how long he intends to continue play-ing. The recent World Cup showed he’s still one of the best players in the world, as did a four-goal display for Inter Miami at the weekend in a 7-1 victory over CF Montreal.

“I leave with the peace of mind and pride of having given you – along with my teammates – moments we once only dreamed of. Experiencing this with you was incredible. I love you all,” he added.

Messi’s stellar recent success with Argentina nearly didn’t happen.

A decade ago he retired from the national team following Argentina’s defeat in the 2016 Copa America final to Chile on penalty kicks – one of which he missed.

A public campaign led by Mara-dona and the president changed his mind and Messi shook off the notion of not being able to win the big matches, returning to the Argen-tina team and continuing to star for Barcelona, then Paris Saint-Germain, then Inter Miami.

He’s the two-time defending Most Valuable Player in Major League Foot-ball, the star of the league champion, someone who still creates goals in the biggest moments.

He’s also a record eight-time world player of the year.

“He is pure history,” Argentina coach Lionel Scaloni said during the recent World Cup. “History. A legend.”

At least 900

devastated northern and central parts of Nepal. The Bhotekoshi River carried the surge south from the Himalayan region, sweeping away homes, vehicles, roads and bridges and damaging several hydropower projects.

Among those caught in the flood-ing were workers at the Mailung Hydropower Project in Rasuwa. Technical employee Shiva Giri and six others escaped by climbing uphill as floodwaters swallowed settle-ments and structures below them. Giri told Nepal News that several of his colleagues, as well as his cousin, were swept away.

With the usual routes to Timure and Dhunche cut off, the group trekked through a forest for about 12 hours before finding a cave where they spent the night. The following day, they descended towards the project area, reported themselves as displaced and called for help. A Nepali Army helicopter later evacu-ated them to Kathmandu, where Giri was receiving treatment at Tribhuvan University Teaching Hospital.

At the Upper Trishuli-1 Hydro-power Project, civil engineer San-dip Rana escaped with around 100

employees after an emergency siren sounded at the project office. The workers were told that a massive flood had struck the dam site about 12 km upstream before they could reach their designated assembly point.

The group climbed towards higher ground and stopped at a loca-tion about 30 to 35 metres above the Trishuli River. From there, they watched the project office, worker camps and roads disappear under the floodwaters.

“We had to keep climbing while also watching for falling stones. There was no time to stop and think,” Rana told The Rising Nepal.

The group spent seven to eight hours climbing before reaching a road in the Grang area at around 4 pm. By the time Rana reached Kalikasthan, only two other people remained with him, while the others had become separated.

Another survivor, identified as Ramchandra, was inside a tunnel along the Trishuli River when water began rushing into the passage. He and five colleagues were hundreds of metres from the exit and used an iron ladder fixed along the tunnel roof to prevent themselves from being swept away.

According to Ratopati, the six men used a sheet of tin for support and moved between ladders for about six hours. “There were six of us, and later we met another person at the tunnel door,” Ramchandra said.

Authorities have so far rescued 279 people from tunnels at hydro-power sites. Rescue efforts are being supported by specialist teams from India and China as Nepal tries to locate workers whose whereabouts remain unknown.

The most difficult operation is under way at the Upper Trishuli-3A Hydropower Project in Nuwakot, where workers are believed to be trapped inside a tunnel buried by debris. A 90-member joint rescue team has been deployed at the site. Nepali Army engineers have used heavy machinery and blasting to widen an opening into the tunnel.

Rescuers reached the main sec-tion and created an opening mea-suring six square feet. They entered through the opening using ropes and called out to anyone who might be inside but received no response. Heavy equipment and controlled blasting were being used together to enlarge the access point and speed up the operation.

The Nepali Army also airlifted dismantled excavators and bulldoz-ers to Battar in Nuwakot to clear the approach to the site. Ratopati reported that the actual tunnel mouth was later located about 40 metres upstream from the vertical opening and about eight metres below it. Res-cuers had not yet reached the work-ers believed to be inside.

The wider search has also been complicated by the destruction of the Bhotekoshi Corridor, Nepal’s main land trade route with China, along with the Rasuwagadhi bor-der crossing between the two coun-tries. In Gorkha, a landslide briefly blocked the Budhi Gandaki River on Monday before water flow resumed. Injured people rescued from flood-hit Rasuwa continued to receive treatment in Kathmandu.

The humanitarian toll has extended beyond Nepal. Chinese media reported that 16 people were killed on the Chinese side and nearly 550 remained missing in Tibet.

India witnessed

conditions in the equatorial Pacific Ocean. Sea surface temper-atures remain above normal across the central and eastern equatorial Pacific and are expected to rise fur-ther in the coming months, he said.

India’s mean temperature in August 2026 was 28.01 degrees Celsius, compared with the nor-mal of 27.34 degrees Celsius, mak-ing it the hottest August since 1901. The average minimum temperature also reached a record high of 24.36 degrees Celsius, against the normal of 23.68 degrees Celsius.

August rainfall stood at 213.3 mm, making it the seventh-lowest August rainfall since 2001. The IMD said moderate to strong El Nino con-ditions were a major factor behind the rainfall shortage. Four low-pressure systems developed during the month and remained active for a combined 26 days. However, their rainfall was largely concentrated over the Indo-Gangetic plains. As a result, several other parts of the country continued to face rainfall deficits.

The September forecast indi-cates that the rainfall shortfall could continue, while temperatures, par-ticularly average maximum tempera-tures, are expected to remain higher than normal.

Briefs

Ex-Madras HC judge missing in Nepal

CHENNAI: The Madras Bar Association on Monday apprised Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Justice of India, Justice Surya Kant that former judge of the Madras High Court, Justice V Sivagnanam has gone missing in Nepal and sought urgent action to search and rescue him. Requesting their urgent intervention, the Bar Association said Justice Sivagnanam has reportedly been missing and untraceable in Nepal since August 26, following the catastrophic floods.

Goa: Anti-conversion bill dropped

PANAJI: In a U-turn following pushback from legislators from the minority community, the Goa government on Monday decided not to introduce its anti-religious conversion bill during the ongoing monsoon session of the state assembly.

Chief Minister
Pramod Sawant conveyed the decision after a meeting with BJP MLAs and an Independent legislator on the opening day of the three-day session.

RSS CHIEF BHAGWAT IN CANADA

'India served world as 'vishwa guru', not as a super power'

SAGAR KULKARNI/PTI
Washington, August 31

RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat said India's civilisational traditions have always been guided by the principle of helping others without discrimination and the country has served the world as 'vishwa guru' and not as a 'super power'.

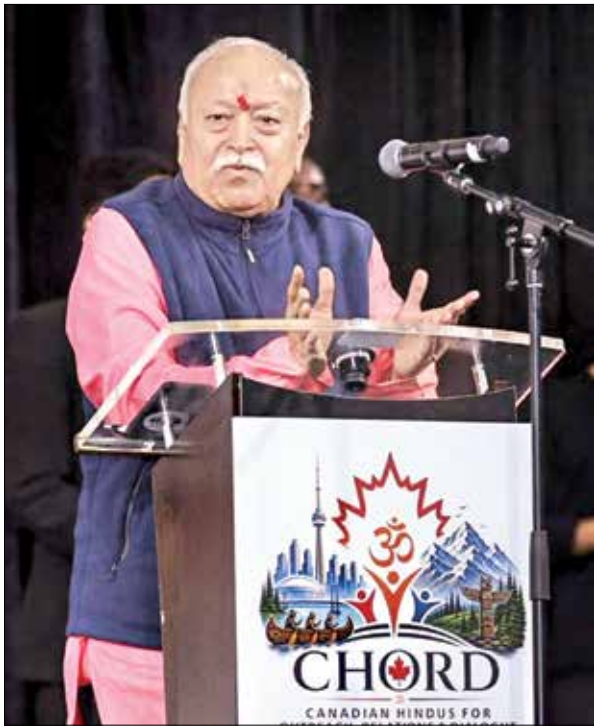
Addressing the 'Hindu Vishwa Bandhu - Embrace the World in Friendship' event organised by Canadian Hindus for Outreach, Relations and Dialogue in Toronto on Sunday, Bhagwat said the Hindu world view was universal in nature and believed in the principle of 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam' or the entire world is one family.

Bhagwat underscored service as the defining feature of 'Bhartiya' civilisational ethos.

“Whenever Bharat has been asked for help anywhere in the world, it has never refused and it extends a helping hand even without even being asked. This is our tradition, the DNA of Bharat. That is why you may have heard the saying-‘If Hindus awaken, the world awakens’,” Bhagwat said.

Bhagwat also quoted Sant Kabir's couplets to assert that all the knowledge acquired by a person is meaningless if he fails to understand the message of love.

“Kabir Maharaj says,



RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat during Bhadrapada Krishna Tritiya 2026, in Toronto, Canada

We are all one. Our interests cannot collide. Because we are one, we have to act as we are one," he said.

Bhagwat also called for embracing diversity while recognising the underlying unity of humanity.

"We have to serve, accept, and respect this diversity because it is an expression of unity. It beautifies it. It is the decoration. We celebrate it," he said.

He said Bharat's ancient ethos recognises diversity as natural while regarding unity as the fundamental reality.

“In nature, the expression of reality is diverse. Diversity is natural. Unity is the reality. That is the ancient ethos of Bharat,” he said.

Bhagwat said Indian spiritual heritage promotes oneness across humanity and nature.

“Those who are open-minded and knowledgeable embrace the concept of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam - the belief that the entire earth is one family,” he said.

“While individuals in the material world may differ in body, shape, and complexion, in essence, we are all one. Therefore, serving others is our duty. We have gained this wisdom, which brings us enduring happiness and lasting contentment,” Bhagwat said.

He said Indians regard both the animate and the inanimate as their own.

SIR: Over 2.06 cr voters excluded from Maharashtra's draft roll

Draft roll currently has more than 7.71 crore voters

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, August 31

**AS MANY AS
2,06,88,487 PEOPLE
HAVE NOT BEEN
INCLUDED, AS THEIR
ENUMERATION FORMS
WERE UNCOLLECTABLE**

crore voters, of whom 78.86 per cent made it to the draft roll.

Pune recorded the highest number of uncollectable enumeration forms at 28.6 lakh, followed by Thane with 28.5 lakh, Mumbai Suburban with 26.5 lakh, Nagpur (14.43 lakh), Nashik (10.27 lakh) and Mumbai City (9.5 lakh), officials said.

The uncollectable forms relate to voters who were absent or could not be found at their registered addresses, had shifted residences, were deceased, had registered elsewhere or had duplicate entries. The cate-

gory also includes voters who declined to fill and submit the enumeration form.

Eligible voters whose names are missing from the draft roll can file claims and objections between August 31 and September 30.

They can seek inclusion by submitting Form 6 along with the required declaration, an objection to an entry can be filed through Form 7, and corrections to details such as name, address, age or gender can be sought through Form 8, it was stated.

Electoral registration officers and their assistants will process claims, objections and notices between August 31 and October 29. The final electoral roll is scheduled to be published on November 4, according to the Election Commission's timetable.

Centre defers census in Manipur after NRC demand by civil society groups

MPOST BUREAU
Imphal, August 31

The Union government on Monday deferred the census operations in Manipur considering the demand by civil society organisations for updating the National Register of Citizens (NRC) before conducting the exercise, an official statement said.

The development came a day before house listing of the census exercise is sched-

uled to begin in the state
from September 1.

The decision to put the operation on hold came after Union Home Minister Amit Shah chaired a high-level review meeting in New Delhi to assess the current situation in Manipur, according to a statement from the Chief Minister's Secretariat.

The demand raised by the people of Manipur to defer the census exercise in

the state before the implementation of the NRC was discussed in the meeting, the statement said.

“The meeting agreed to defer the proposed Census exercise in the state considering the feelings and aspirations of the people of Manipur,” it said. Manipur Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla, CM Y Khemchand Singh and other officials attended the meeting.



Ministry of Civil Aviation
Government of India



**Map for representation purpose only*

Ahmedabad Takes Flight to the World

One Check-in. Seamless Connections. Endless Possibilities.

A New Milestone in India's Aviation Journey
An initiative towards Making India a global aviation Hub

Inauguration of

Hub and Spoke Flight
Connecting Ahmedabad to the World via Delhi

By

Shri Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu
Hon'ble Union Minister of Civil Aviation

Tuesday, 1st September, 2026

Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport, Ahmedabad



ONE CHECK-IN



SEAMLESS JOURNEY



IMMIGRATION AND CUSTOMS AT AHMEDABAD



CONNECTED THROUGH DELHI



BAGS DIRECTLY DELIVERED TO DESTINATION



ROOTED IN HERITAGE



REACHING THE WORLD



"India has transitioned from an aviation-exclusive to an aviation-inclusive country"

Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister



CBC 03101/13/0003/2627

EDITORIAL

Beyond The
Headline Growth

India's economy has begun the new financial year with impressive momentum. Gross domestic product expanded by 7.8 per cent year-on-year in the April-June quarter of 2026-27, comfortably exceeding market expectations of around 7.1 per cent and the Reserve Bank of India's projection of 7 per cent. Manufacturing grew by 9.2 per cent, financial services by 12.1 per cent, while investment and consumption provided substantial support. Private investment, in particular, appears to be gathering momentum after years in which public capital expenditure carried much of the burden of investment creation. Gross value added grew by 8.2 per cent, suggesting that the headline number is supported by reasonably broad economic activity. India consequently remains among the fastest-growing major economies at a time when geopolitical tensions, expensive energy and uncertain global trade are weighing on many countries.

Yet strong GDP numbers should invite ambition rather than complacency. The question is no longer simply whether India can sustain growth above 7 per cent, but whether such growth can translate into better livelihoods across income groups. A rapidly expanding economy needs to generate employment at a pace commensurate with the millions entering the workforce. Manufacturing growth is especially encouraging because India's long-term development requires a larger productive base capable of absorbing workers moving out of low-productivity agriculture. The revival of private capital expenditure must therefore deepen beyond capital-intensive sectors and reach smaller manufacturers, labour-intensive industries and enterprises outside the largest urban centres. Growth that produces investment without sufficient employment will eventually encounter social as well as economic limits.

Consumption provides another important test. Tax relief and easing inflation have helped household demand, but sustained consumption cannot depend indefinitely on fiscal measures. It must ultimately be supported by rising real incomes. The performance of rural India will be particularly important in the coming quarters. Agriculture supports a substantial share of the population, while nearly half of farmland remains without irrigation, leaving rural incomes vulnerable to rainfall fluctuations. Meanwhile, elevated global oil prices remain a significant external risk because India imports roughly 85 per cent of its crude requirement. Expensive energy can feed inflation, weaken household purchasing power, pressure the rupee and complicate monetary policy.

The 7.8 per cent expansion is therefore an achievement worth recognising, but GDP must remain a means rather than an end. India now needs to convert macroeconomic momentum into productive employment, stronger household incomes, competitive manufacturing and broader opportunities for smaller businesses. Infrastructure investment, fiscal discipline and private capital formation remain essential, but the ultimate measure of economic progress is whether ordinary citizens experience greater financial security and upward mobility. India has demonstrated that it can grow rapidly despite an uncertain world. The harder task is ensuring that the benefits of that growth travel further and reach more people.

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Gracias, Leo

Lionel Messi's international retirement closes a glorious chapter in football. From painful final defeats to lifting the World Cup, his journey with Argentina embodied perseverance. Beyond records and trophies, Messi gave generations unforgettable moments. The world may find new heroes, but replacing his influence, artistry and presence will be impossible.

GAUTAM KAPOOR,
BANGALORE

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

An Unequal Burden

Despite contributing almost nothing to global emissions, Nepal faces enormous climate costs as Himalayan risks intensify and adaptation drains scarce development resources

CLIMATE
LEDGER



JOHN FELIX RAJ
& SOVIK MUKHERJEE

JF RAJ IS THE VC, S MUKHERJE IS
AN ASSISTANT PROFESSOR AT ST
XAVIER'S UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA

With a negligible contribution to global emissions but extraordinary exposure to Himalayan climate risks, Nepal reveals an uncomfortable truth: the climate crisis is fundamentally a crisis of economic inequality.

On August 26, 2026, a massive collapse of glacial ice and rock in Nepal's Langtang region near the Tibetan border triggered devastating flash floods. The torrent swept through settlements and vital infrastructure, claiming hundreds of lives. This disaster occurred against a troubling broader backdrop: accelerating global warming is destabilising the fragile Himalayan environment and rapidly driving glacier retreat.

There is something fundamentally unfair about the eco-

nomics of climate change. The nations that built their wealth on fossil-fuel emissions are rarely the ones facing its gravest consequences—a contradiction Nepal captures with disturbing clarity. Why should a country that contributed almost nothing to the climate crisis bear such a disproportionate share of its costs?

Frontline without fault

The numbers are striking. According to Global Carbon Budget data, Nepal accounted for barely 0.05% of global fossil-fuel and industrial CO₂ emissions in 2024. Its historical footprint is even smaller, representing roughly 0.01% of cumulative global emissions since 1751. Yet its climate exposure is acute. UNDP reports rank Nepal fourth globally in climate vulnerability, with 21 of the 47 highest-risk glacial lakes in the Hindu Kush Himalaya situated within its borders. The contrast is stark: 0.05% of global emissions, yet positioned on the front lines of global climate risk.

Costs keep compounding

The economic toll of a climate shock extends far beyond immediate physical destruction. When a bridge collapses, farmers lose access to markets, workers lose jobs, and patients lose access to healthcare. When hydropower infrastructure breaks, energy grids fail. When arable land is washed away, food security vanishes overnight.

The September 2024 floods and landslides exposed this systemic fragility, killing 249 people, displacing 11,000 families, and devastating local property. For low-income households, these recurring losses trigger



Nepal emits just 0.05%, yet bears others' climate costs

THE ECONOMIC TOLL
OF A CLIMATE SHOCK
EXTENDS FAR BEYOND
IMMEDIATE PHYSICAL
DESTRUCTION

spiralling debt and deeper poverty—turning climate exposure into an inequality multiplier.

Asymmetric carbon costs

In economic terms, carbon emissions are a classic negative externality: the financial benefits of industrial growth accrue to major polluters, while the environmental costs are shifted onto vulnerable non-polluters.

This injustice is compounded by disparities in adaptive capacity. High-income economies possess resilient infrastructure, mature insurance markets, advanced technology, and

deep fiscal reserves. Developing nations have virtually no fiscal room to absorb repeated catastrophic shocks. Climate inequality is therefore not just about who polluted more, but who can afford to recover.

Resilience versus development

Nepal is not shirking its environmental duties. In May 2025, the nation pledged to reduce net greenhouse gas emissions by 17.12% by 2030 and 26.79% by 2035—an ambitious stance given its tiny footprint.

Meanwhile, the world's top current emitters—China and the United States—account for roughly 32% and 13% of global CO₂ emissions, respectively, while holding the financial and technological capacity to withstand climate shocks. Nepal estimates its climate adaptation costs alone will reach \$18-20 billion between 2025 and 2035—funds desperately needed for basic healthcare, education, and infrastructure.

The core question is not whether Nepal must build climate resilience—it has no choice. The question is who should pay for it.

Finance beyond charity

International support for vulnerable nations must not be framed as Western generosity. It is grounded in historical responsibility, relative capacity to pay, and financial compensation for global externalities.

Nepal urgently requires advanced glacier monitoring, early warning systems, resilient infrastructure, and climate-smart agriculture. However, local adaptation cannot become an excuse for the international community to transfer the global climate bill onto victim nations.

This issue demands a regional response. Himalayan glaciers and river systems cross international boundaries. South Asian neighbours—including India and Nepal—share an immediate interest in establishing cross-border disaster monitoring networks and integrated early-warning systems.

Settling climate debts

Nepal forces a reckoning with how the world views climate change. The crisis is not just a calculation of metric tons of carbon or fractions of a degree of warming. It is an issue of accountability: who emitted, who profited, who suffers, and who pays. A country responsible for 0.05% of global emissions should not be forced to drain its development budgets to survive a crisis it did not create. Nepal contributed virtually nothing to the climate bill, yet the destabilised Himalayas are demanding that it pay in full.

Views expressed are personal

Financing India's Space Future

Vikram-1 proves private space potential, but sustainable growth needs deeper domestic financing

BEYOND
THE ORBIT



VIKAS GUPTA
& AKSHITA SINGH

V GUPTA IS AREA CHAIR, A SINGH
IS A STUDENT, BOTH AT OP
JINDAL GLOBAL UNIVERSITY

Recently, in July 2026, a seven-storey rocket built entirely by an Indian startup lifted off from Sriharikota. 15 minutes later, Skyroot Aerospace's Vikram-1 was in orbit, 450 kilometres up.

India became only the third country – after the United States and China – where a private company has independently designed, built and flown its own rocket into orbit. Not a government agency, not a legacy defence contractor, but a startup founded in 2018 by two former ISRO engineers who left their jobs with ten people and \$1.5 million in seed money.

"Hello space, we have arrived." Prime Minister Modi called it something that would encourage young Indians to dream bigger.

A launch is a single afternoon. What matters is what follows: India has a rocket in orbit and no clear way to fund the next hundred.

Six years, four hundred companies, half a billion dollars

In 2014, India had one registered space startup. It now has

more than 400. The government opened the sector to private players in 2020, stood up IN-SPaCe as regulator in 2022, allowed 100% foreign investment in satellite manufacturing in 2023, and approved a Rs 1,000 crore venture fund for space startups in October 2024 – sized for roughly 40 companies.

The numbers that followed: Indian space companies raised over \$500 million cumulatively between 2020 and 2024, and close to \$200 million more in 2025. Skyroot itself raised \$60 million months before launch, co-led by Sherpa Ventures and Singapore's GIC, at a \$1.1 billion valuation – India's first space unicorn. Pixxel, Agnikul Cosmos and Digantara have each raised credible rounds too. The sector has shed its novelty. It has not shed its scale problem.

Who is actually writing the cheques?

Large rounds are led by Temasek and GIC out of Singapore, Lightspeed, Mayfield, Google and BlackRock out of the US, and Peak XV – Sequoia's India arm, but a global fund at heart. Indian mutual funds, insurers and family offices are almost entirely absent.

That is structural, not cosmetic. Venture capital runs on a seven-to-ten-year clock, while rockets take years to certify and satellites run on manufacturing cycles that simply do not fit VC timelines. Germany's Isar Aerospace, which is around the same age as Skyroot, has raised nearly \$900 million but has still not achieved a successful orbital launch as of its latest attempt. Compared with India's numbers, the bigger question isn't why Isar raised so much but why Indian companies raise so little, from so few investors, while domestic capital largely stays away.

Foreign capital is present, but domestic capital is missing, and this gap could determine whether the sector grows or struggles. Closing it will require



Vikram-1 reached orbit. The harder journey has just started

INDIA HAS ITS FIRST
PRIVATE ORBITAL
ROCKET. THE HARDER
QUESTION IS WHO
FUNDS THE NEXT
HUNDRED

banks to lend against space assets, insurers to cover satellite risk, and equity markets to provide a clear exit. India has not had a single space-startup IPO yet.

The SpaceX shadow, and the Starlink fight ahead

Elon Musk's role in the private space industry is difficult to overlook. SpaceX listed on the Nasdaq in June 2026 at roughly \$1.75 trillion, the largest IPO in history, months after Tesla converted a \$2 billion xAI investment into SpaceX equity. Starlink is now in talks with India's telecom ministry; Reliance is reportedly building a rival constellation. India's sky is becoming a contest between the world's richest man and one of India's.

For Indian startups, SpaceX is an inspiration, benchmark

and competitor at once. Its reusable-rocket economics cut launch costs from roughly \$54,000 per kilogram to under \$3,000 today – the same cost collapse that makes Vikram-1 viable. Skyroot does not need to beat Falcon 9; it needs to serve customers for whom Falcon 9 is too large, too expensive or geographically inconvenient. That market is real and crowded – Rocket Lab, Isar Aerospace and Chinese launchers are chasing it too.

The capital deficit

Mint highlighted a major concern in its coverage: access to capital remains one of the industry's biggest hurdles. The government wants the space economy to grow from \$8.4 billion to \$44 billion by 2033 – five times its current size in seven years. Isar Aerospace alone has raised nearly as much as India's entire private space sector raised in five years. The US raised \$2.9 billion for space startups in 2024 alone. India's \$500 million is a start, but it is not enough to close the gap, especially when the sector needs patient, long-term capital.

There is also limited data on where India's space funding goes, which companies receive it, at what stage or on what terms. There is no Indian PitchBook for the space sector. A

2026 *Politecnico di Milano* study mapped venture-funded space startups across Europe and the US, classifying over 113,000 companies. No similar study exists for India, partly because the necessary data is not readily available. The gap is not engineering – Vikram-1 has already shown that Indian companies can build. Finance, data and research remain major gaps.

What a real space economy requires

Rocket Lab took seven years and dozens of launches to approach profitability. SpaceX's launch business became viable with Falcon 9's reusable technology. One successful launch does not make an industry.

Reaching \$44 billion by 2033 requires imaging companies, reliable domestic manufacturing and clear rules on spectrum and liability. Financing is equally important. Space bonds and revenue-based financing for long-gestation deep-tech companies remain largely untested. The government's Rs 1,000 crore fund is expected to support 40 companies, while many more need capital.

India has built this kind of infrastructure before in telecom and fintech. The challenge is now to do the same for space.

Vikram-1 reached orbit. The harder journey has just started.

Vikram-2 is under development, targeting 900 kilograms to low Earth orbit by late 2027, with commercial operations planned for 2028. Skyroot now has a road-map, investors and a successful orbital launch behind it.

India's space sector now has proof that private companies can build orbital rockets and attract global investment. What it still lacks is the financial depth to sustain that progress – and building that financial base, though less visible than a rocket launch, will be one of the sector's biggest challenges over the next decade.

Views expressed are personal

Prosperity Outruns Social Civility

Urban progress means little without dignity, empathy and mutual human respect

URBAN FAULTLINES



BHOPINDER SINGH

THE WRITER IS A FORMER LT GOVERNOR OF ANDAMAN AND NICOBAR & PUDUCHERRY

A woman in a Greater Noida housing society, in full public view, ranted at security guards in language so laced with casteist, classist and racist contempt that the episode seemed to belong to another India. Yet it happened in one of the gleaming residential enclaves of the National Capital Region – a landscape of high-rise towers, manicured avenues, clubhouses, security gates and aspirational lifestyles. There was something more disturbing about the episode than merely one person’s bad behaviour. It exposed a fault line running through the new NCR: what happens when material mobility advances faster than social civility?

The outer fringes of Delhi-

NCR are among the most visible manifestations of an India in transition. Places that were once villages, agricultural fields and peri-urban settlements have become apartment clusters, gated communities, commercial districts and satellite cities. People come here for perfectly understandable reasons. Delhi and its surrounding cities offer employment, education, health-care, institutions, connectivity and opportunity. For a young professional, middle-class family, entrepreneur or employee, a flat in a modern condominium may represent years of savings, EMIs and sacrifice. For many, having such a home, whether owned or rented, is the tangible result of hard work and the desire for a better life.

For another set of families, the story is different but equally tied to the transformation of the region. Agricultural land that once sustained farming communities has been acquired or sold as the city expanded. Some land-owning families have become investors, landlords or entrepreneurs; others have simply exchanged an agrarian livelihood for a place in the new urban economy. And then there are the millions who make these new cities function without necessarily sharing in their prosperity – for example, security guards, domestic workers, drivers, cleaners, construction workers, delivery personnel and maintenance staff.

Behind the gates of the modern NCR condominium lies, therefore, a remarkable social experiment. The rich and the not-so-rich live cheek by jowl. The person who owns the

penthouse and the person who guards its entrance may inhabit the same physical complex, yet occupy radically different positions in its social hierarchy.

The distinction between the haves and the have-nots is usually measured in income, property, cars, square footage, education or purchasing power. But there is another distinction that wealth cannot purchase: the distinction between dignity and indignity, between civility and vulgarity, between self-respect and entitlement.

A security guard may earn a modest salary and live in circumstances vastly removed from those of the residents he protects. That does not make him lesser as a human being. Conversely, owning a luxury apartment does not confer nobility. A large home is not evidence of a large character. A premium car does not come with a licence for humiliation. A substantial bank balance cannot purchase manners at the gate.

For generations, Indians were taught that education, employment, enterprise, savings and hard work could enable a family to rise. That promise is one of the great achievements of urbanisation and economic liberalisation. The first generation acquires land; the next builds a house; the next moves into a condominium. A family that once worried about subsistence may now worry about school fees, club memberships and property prices. There is nothing shameful about this aspiration. The desire to live better is one of the great engines of development. But prosperity carries a moral hazard.



In an urban society, wealth may determine purchasing power, but it cannot determine human worth

CIVILITY IS ONE OF THE FEW FORMS OF EQUALITY AVAILABLE IN AN UNEQUAL SOCIETY

The newly affluent can sometimes mistake the privileges acquired through economic mobility for evidence of inherent superiority. That is where

prosperity can curdle into entitlement. And entitlement has an especially ugly vocabulary in India. It can express itself through caste, contempt for someone’s occupation, the assumption that a uniform denotes inferiority, or the belief that money confers the right to shout, threaten and humiliate.

The irony is that genuine social confidence rarely needs such demonstrations. The truly secure person does not need to humiliate the waiter to establish status. The accomplished person does not need to remind the guard that he is poor. The per-

son comfortable with his own dignity has little incentive to strip another person of theirs. Civility is one of the few forms of equality available in an unequal society.

A guard may not be able to match a resident’s income, property or social capital. But resident and guard can still meet as human beings – with a greeting, a request rather than an order, an explanation rather than an insult, and disagreement without degradation. That is not charity. It is civilisation.

The Greater Noida episode should, therefore, be understood as something larger than a social-media spectacle or another “society fight” video. It should make us ask what kind of cities we are building. Are we merely constructing taller buildings, wider roads, shopping malls and gated enclaves? Or are we creating urban citizens capable of living with people unlike themselves?

Because the new NCR will become increasingly diverse and increasingly unequal at the same time. Its apartments will contain professionals, entrepreneurs, bureaucrats, retirees, migrants and families whose fortunes have been made in radically different ways. Its service economy will depend upon people from villages and small towns, speaking different languages and coming from different communities.

The same elevator may carry a millionaire and a delivery worker. The same road may carry a luxury SUV and a bicycle. The same gate may be crossed daily by residents and those employed to serve them.

Urbanisation does not erase social hierarchies. It brings them into closer proximity. The challenge of a modern city is, therefore, not simply to accommodate inequality, but to prevent inequality from becoming humiliation.

This is where Viksit Bharat must acquire a meaning beyond infrastructure and GDP. A developed country is not merely one with expressways, airports, high-rises and smart cities. It is one in which the ordinary citizen understands that another person’s occupation does not determine his worth. Development must produce a culture in which the security guard is not an obstacle at the gate but a fellow citizen performing an essential service; where the domestic worker is not invisible; where the delivery rider is not disposable; and where the driver is not expected to absorb abuse because he needs the salary.

Most importantly, those who have succeeded economically must understand that success increases one’s responsibilities to society rather than one’s licence to demean it. The real divide in these new cities, therefore, is not simply between the rich and the poor. It is between those who understand dignity and those who don’t.

The true test of the new NCR will not be the height of its towers. It will be what happens at the gates. Because no gated community, however grand, can protect anyone from this simple truth: the guard can possess dignity. The billionaire can lose it. And neither comes with an income bracket.

Views expressed are personal

Profitability is a Security Imperative

India’s private security industry needs professional, technology-enabled and financially sustainable solutions

STRATEGIC SHIELD



KUNWAR VIKRAM SINGH

THE WRITER IS THE CHAIRMAN, CENTRAL ASSOCIATION OF PRIVATE SECURITY INDUSTRY

India’s private security industry stands at an important crossroads. With millions of security personnel deployed across the country, private security has evolved far beyond its traditional role of guarding premises. Private security personnel protect residential communities, businesses, institutions, logistics networks and critical infrastructure. The industry is an important component of India’s security architecture.

Yet there is a paradox that deserves urgent attention.

Many security agencies are reporting substantial growth in turnover but are struggling to generate adequate profits. Some are carrying significant working-capital pressures and statutory liabilities despite having large contracts and thousands of personnel.

This raises a fundamental question: Can an industry that is financially fragile provide sustainable security to the nation? The answer is clearly no.

The turnover trap

Private security is one of the most manpower-intensive

businesses in India. A very substantial portion of the revenue of a security agency goes towards salaries and statutory employment costs. Every new contract, therefore, requires additional working capital, recruitment, training, uniforms, supervision, administration and compliance.

When contracts are won at margins that do not adequately cover the actual cost of delivering professional security, an agency may experience the illusion of growth: turnover increases while profitability stagnates.

The private security industry must now stop measuring success primarily in terms of the number of guards deployed or the annual turnover achieved. The real measures must be profitability, productivity, cash flow, employee retention, customer satisfaction and the quality of security delivered.

The LI culture must change

One of the greatest threats to the industry’s sustainability is the continuing emphasis on lowest-price procurement. A trained security professional protecting a bank, hospital, data centre, port or power installation cannot be treated as a commodity purchased solely on price. When contracts are awarded primarily to the lowest bidder, agencies are encouraged to reduce prices beyond sustainable levels.

The consequences affect the security agency, its employees and the customer, while breeding corruption and exploitation that go against the basic ethics on which the concept of security is built. India needs to move towards value-based security procurement, where training, manpower quality, technology, supervision, statutory compliance, experience and measurable security outcomes are given appropriate weight. Competitive bidding should remain, but competition should be based on value rather than



The industry needs a new economic and professional framework

A FINANCIALLY WEAK PRIVATE SECURITY INDUSTRY CANNOT RELIABLY PROTECT THE NATION

simply the lowest number.

Tackling high attrition

High attrition is another serious challenge. Every security professional who leaves creates recruitment, verification, training, uniform, deployment and replacement costs, besides the loss of experience and familiarity with the site. The industry must create a professional career structure in which a young person joining as a security guard can aspire to become a senior guard, supervisor, Guarding Officer, security manager and, eventually, a senior security professional. This is why the concept of Guarding Officer deserves serious national consideration. The transformation of the security guard into a professionally trained and certified Guarding Officer can improve dignity, productivity, retention and the quality of security itself.

The working-capital crisis

Security agencies have to pay their personnel every month, irrespective of whether their customers have paid their invoices. When customer payments are delayed by 60 or 90 days, the security company is effectively financing the customer’s security operation. The newly introduced Wage Codes by the Ministry of Labour & Employment have made significant changes, but their implementation, especially compliance by service takers, remains to be seen.

For a large agency employing thousands of personnel, this can involve tens of crores of rupees in working capital. Borrowing to finance delayed receivables further reduces already thin margins. There is, therefore, an urgent need for a 30-day payment discipline for security services, particularly for undisputed invoices. Contracts should also provide for automatic revision of billing rates when minimum wages, statutory contributions or government-mandated costs change. A professional security agency should not be expected to absorb every increase in the cost of compliance.

Supplier to partner

For decades, the private

security industry has largely sold manpower. The future must sell security solutions. A modern security solution could integrate trained Guarding Officers with CCTV analytics, access control, command centres, remote monitoring, mobile patrols, sensors, drones and digital incident-management systems. Technology should not simply increase the cost of security. It should increase security productivity, enabling fewer but better-trained personnel to deliver a higher level of protection.

Specialisation creates value

The next phase of growth must also be driven by specialisation. CAPSI has already submitted its Surakshit Bharat Vision-2047 to the Ministry of Home Affairs. The security requirements of a data centre are different from those of a residential complex. Protecting a port, airport, power plant, pharmaceutical facility or financial institution requires specialised skills.

Private security companies must, therefore, increasingly develop vertical expertise in critical infrastructure, ports and airports, data centres, banking and financial services, logistics and warehousing, industrial, pharmaceutical and health-

care facilities, as well as electronic, remote and integrated cyber-physical security

When an agency sells expertise and measurable outcomes rather than simply manpower, it can escape the destructive cycle of commodity pricing.

Consolidation enables growth

The fragmented nature of the industry also needs attention. Smaller security agencies often lack the resources to invest independently in advanced training, technology, command centres and professional management. Strategic alliances, shared technology platforms, common training facilities, joint command centres and consolidation can help address these limitations. The objective should not necessarily be to create fewer companies. It should be to create stronger companies.

A national agenda for PSI 2.0
The private security industry now needs a new economic and professional framework. I believe PSI 2.0 should be built around six principles:

- **Profitable Contracts** – Agencies must know their true costs before bidding.
- **Productive People** – Training, dignity, welfare and career progression must become central to the business model.
- **Technology Enablement** – Technology must increase productivity and security effectiveness.
- **Professional Specialisation** – Agencies should develop expertise in critical and high-value sectors.
- **Financial Discipline** – Receivables, working capital and contract-level profitability must receive board-level attention.
- **Professional Regulation** – PSARA 2.0, quality standards and rating mechanisms should reward compliant and professional agencies.

Profitability is not ‘selfish’

There is sometimes a perception that demanding better margins for private security companies is merely an industry demand. It is much more than that. A profitable security company can pay its employees on time, invest in training and technology, maintain adequate supervision, provide better welfare, comply with regulations, retain experienced personnel and respond effectively to emergencies.

In other words, profitability creates security capability. A financially weak agency cannot continuously invest in the capabilities that modern India requires.

Changing the narrative

India needs a private security industry that is not merely large but strong, professional, technologically capable and financially sustainable. The industry must move from guards to Guarding Officers, manpower to security solutions, LI procurement to value-based procurement, turnover to profitable growth, delayed payments to financial discipline, fragmented operations to strategic collaboration, and traditional guarding to integrated security.

The private security industry is ready for this transformation. The Government, industry, customers and employees must now work together to make it happen.

India’s security requirements are expanding rapidly, critical infrastructure is becoming increasingly complex and technology is changing the nature of threats. The objective of PSI 2.0 should not be to make the private security industry merely bigger, but to make it profitable enough to invest, professional enough to deliver and strong enough to become a dependable partner in India’s national security ecosystem.

That is not merely good business. It is a national security imperative.

Views expressed are personal

Briefs

Ladakh to get 30 smart bus shelters

LEH: Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on Monday laid the foundation stone for 30 smart bus shelters, with 15 each planned in Leh and Kargil. Designed for the region's harsh weather, the shelters will feature GPS-based bus tracking, real-time ETAs, CCTV, SOS buttons, first-aid kits and emergency oxygen. Each facility will also have a 2 KW solar power system.

Committed to Punjab's welfare: CM

CHANDIGARH: Punjab CM Bhagwant Singh Mann on Monday said his government was committed to using public money for welfare and development and would not be deterred by Opposition pressure. At a programme in Rajpura, he said the government was focused on jobs, healthcare and education. He also highlighted schemes providing financial assistance to women, pilgrimage facilities and cashless healthcare, and said Punjab's tradition of communal harmony must be preserved.

Power cuts spark unique protest in UP

LUCKNOW: Frustrated over prolonged power cuts, villagers in Gonda allegedly made a junior engineer take an oath on the Hanuman Chalisa and disclose the daily electricity supply hours. The incident occurred at the Katra Bazar power substation on Friday night. Villagers claimed several areas had received less than two hours of regular power daily for six months.

Loan fraud: Banker held in Odisha

BHUBANESWAR: The EOW of Odisha Police arrested a bank officer for his alleged involvement in fraudulent sanction of gold loans and misappropriation of Rs 2.12 crore. The accused, identified as Satyabrata Bhoi, the then branch manager of a public sector bank, was arrested based on a case registered by the bank's Balasore region head.

HP police station IED blast: 3 held

NEW DELHI: The NIA has arrested three more persons in connection with the January 1 IED blast at Nalagarh Police Station in Himachal Pradesh. The agency took over the probe on May 8. The arrested accused, Arshdeep Singh alias Arsh Kandola, Karanpartap and Diljot Saini, are residents of SBS Nagar district in Punjab, the agency said.

‘CAPABILITIES THAT ONLY A FEW NAVIES HAVE’

INS Nipun joins Navy fleet, boosting its deep-sea diving and rescue power

MPOST BUREAU

Mumbai, August 31

The Indian Navy on Monday commissioned INS Nipun, a deep-sea diving vessel to support complex operations, marking a significant enhancement in underwater support capabilities that only a few navies have, officials said.

This is the second such deep-sea diving vessel commissioned into the Indian Navy after INS Nistar last year.

INS Nipun was commissioned in the presence of Navy chief Admiral Krishna Swaminathan in Mumbai.

Along with her sister ship INS Nistar, INS Nipun substantially enhances the Navy's specialist diving, underwater intervention, salvage and submarine rescue support capability, officials said.

It brings together a range of capabilities possessed by only a handful of navies, which includes the ability to embark the Indian Navy's deep submergence rescue vessel, Admiral Swaminathan said after the commissioning of INS Nipun.

The ship has the capacity to support diving operations up to 300 metres. It also has the capability of providing rapid submarine rescue. It can also be deployed for disaster relief and humanitarian operations, the Navy said.

Indigenously designed and constructed by Hindustan Shipyard Limited,



Chief of the Naval Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan, Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan, and others, during the commissioning ceremony of INS Nipun

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » This is the second such deep-sea diving vessel commissioned into the Indian Navy after INS Nistar last year
- » INS Nipun was commissioned in the presence of Navy chief Admiral Krishna Swaminathan in Mumbai
- » This substantially enhances the Navy's specialist diving, underwater intervention, salvage and submarine rescue support capability

Visakhapatnam, the vessel is 119.4 metres long with a capacity of 10,500 tonnes.

INS Nipun is a purpose-built platform designed primarily for deep-sea diving and underwater operations. The ship is capable of supporting sat-

uration, air and heliox diving and is equipped with remotely operated underwater systems for inspection and intervention. Its specialised diving complex, dynamic positioning capability and associated life-support and medical facilities enable the con-

duct of sustained and complex operations at sea, the Navy said.

The ship is also capable of supporting submarine rescue operations, further strengthening the Indian Navy's ability to respond to underwater contingencies.

Its crest and motto embody the spirit of its specialised role and the men who venture into the depths. The motto, 'Far Beneath, Few Beyond', reflects the resolve, skill and endurance required to operate in one of the most challenging domains of the maritime environment, the Navy said.

"Nipun adds specialised capability to support complex underwater

operations and respond to emergencies in one of the most demanding and mysterious environments known to the world," Admiral Swaminathan said.

Submarine rescue, in particular, is a discipline where preparedness admits little margin for delay.

"Nipun's ability to embark and operate the Indian Navy's deep submergence rescue vessel significantly enhances our capacity to respond to a distressed submarine quite significantly - whether our own, or that of a partner Navy. This capability would also enable India to support submarine rescue and emerge as the 'Preferred Submarine Rescue Partner' in the region," the Navy chief said.

In addition, INS Nipun's specialised diving capabilities can support partner nations in underwater salvage and HADR (Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief) missions, adding another dimension to the Navy's maritime cooperation efforts.

"Commissioning a platform is only one part of capability creation. The real measure of induction is how rapidly and effectively we can convert a new platform into operational capability," Admiral Swaminathan said.

Balyan murder: Two 'suspects' killed in encounter in Shamli

Gogi gang role under probe: DGP



Union MoS Jayant Chaudhary meets family members of Ankit Balyan

PTI

MPOST BUREAU

Shamli, August 31

Two suspected sharpshooters carrying a reward of Rs 50,000 each in the murder of Haryana singer and YouTuber Ankit Balyan were killed in a police encounter in Shamli on Monday, as Uttar Pradesh Police said the probe had uncovered a pre-planned conspiracy involving a network linked to the Gogi gang.

The accused, Mohit (22) and Sumit (24), both from Sonapat in Haryana, were killed in retaliatory firing after police intercepted a car near an Indian Gas warehouse on Kairana Road, officials said.

Shamli Superintendent of Police Narendra Pratap Singh said the occupants allegedly tried to flee and opened fire at the police team, triggering an exchange of gunfire. The two suspects sustained bullet injuries and were taken to the District Joint Hospital, where doctors declared them dead.

Two SWAT personnel,

Head Constables Harvinder and Pradeep, were also injured in the exchange. Police said three pistols and 26 cartridges were recovered from the suspects. Mohit had around 14 criminal cases registered against him in Haryana, while Sumit had one case.

Balyan was shot dead on August 26 after leaving a gym in Shamli's Kotwali area. Police said four assailants riding two motorcycles opened fire on him as he walked towards his car. He suffered five gunshot injuries, including two to the head.

Uttar Pradesh DGP Rajeev Krishna said the investigation indicated that the killing was carefully planned, with the attackers tracking Balyan's movements, obtaining weapons from outside and arranging their escape. The shooters allegedly changed their hideouts repeatedly after the murder.

He said the probe had pointed towards a network associated with the Gogi gang.

Hry CM: HKRN 'eliminated' middlemen from contractual jobs

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, Aug 31

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday said the Haryana Kaushal Rozgar Nigam (HKRN) had eliminated contractors and middlemen from the state's contractual employment system, replacing it with a transparent and employee-oriented mechanism.

Speaking in the Vidhan Sabha during a discussion on a Calling Attention Motion on HKRN, Saini said the earlier contractor-driven system had led to wage deductions, exploitation and uncertainty among young employees.

He said HKRN was not a replacement for regular government recruitment but an interim arrangement to ensure essential services continued while regular appointments were undertaken through the Haryana Staff Selection Commission and Haryana Public Service Commission.

Leader of Opposition Bhopinder Singh Hooda, however, demanded regularisation of HKRN employees and said future government recruitment should be made only through regular appointments. Congress members alleged that contractual hiring through HKRN was increasingly bypassing constitutional recruitment bodies. Saini rejected the criticism, saying the opposition had developed an "HKRN phobia". He maintained that temporary employment had existed in Haryana for decades and did not begin with the creation of HKRN.

Saini said HKRN had brought contractual employment under a framework based on merit, rules and social security.

Bihar, J'khand sign Sone water-sharing pact in Shah's presence

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 31

Bihar and Jharkhand on Monday signed an agreement to share the waters of the Sone River, resolving a dispute between the two states that had remained unsettled for nearly 25 years.

The Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was signed in the presence of Union Home and Cooperation minister Amit Shah. Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren, Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Chaudhary, Union Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil, Bihar Deputy Chief Minister, Union Home Secretary and senior officials of the Centre and both states attended the event.

Shah described the agreement as a landmark settlement of the long-standing water-sharing issue in eastern India. He said the arrangement would facilitate irrigation for lakhs of farmers in Bihar and Jharkhand while



also helping meet drinking water requirements.

In Bihar, the agreement is expected to benefit Bhojpur, Buxar, Rohtas, Kaimur, Aurangabad, Arwal, Gaya and Patna districts. Palamu and Garhwa districts in Jharkhand will also receive water for irrigation and drinking purposes.

Shah said the agreement demonstrated Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision of "Team Bharat" and the principle of cooperative federalism. He said disputes between states, irrespective of how long they had persisted, could be resolved through dialogue and cooperation when the larger interests

LEAVES BEHIND A RICH POLITICAL AND LITERARY LEGACY

Lucknow's 88-year-old Indian Coffee House shuts down

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Lucknow, August 31

For nearly three months, the doors of Lucknow's 88-year-old Indian Coffee House have remained closed, leaving one of the city's historic meeting places silent. For decades, the establishment served as a gathering point for politicians, journalists, writers, artists and social activists.

In the pre-social media era, political leaders and journalists regularly met here over inexpensive cups of coffee, exchanging information, debating developments and



FILE PIC

sometimes shaping news stories through informal conversations.

The Coffee House's history is closely linked with Uttar Pradesh's political life. Former prime ministers Jawaharlal Nehru, Atal Bihari Vajpayee and Chandra Shekhar, social-

ist leader Ram Manohar Lohia, Acharya Narendra Dev and former chief ministers Vir Bahadur Singh and N D Tiwari were among the prominent figures associated with the venue. George Fernandes, Mulayam Singh Yadav and Lalji Tandon also had links

with the institution.

Writer and journalist Pradeep Kapoor, author of 'Lucknow ka Coffee House', said the closure represented the loss of an iconic public space. He recalled that Vir Bahadur Singh would visit without an official entourage and

KEY POINTS

- » In the pre-social media era, political leaders and journalists regularly met here over inexpensive cups of coffee
- » Pradeep Kapoor, author of 'Lucknow ka Coffee House', said the closure represented the loss of an iconic public space

sit with journalists and intellectuals. After resigning as chief minister in 1988, Singh reportedly visited the Coffee House soon afterwards.

Former prime minister Chandra Shekhar also visited the venue during his 2002 Lucknow visit, while Tandon famously regarded it as his "political school", Kapoor said.

The Coffee House was equally important to Lucknow's literary and cultural circles. Writers and poets including Yashpal, Majaz Lakhnavi, Amritlal Nagar, Madan Mohan Siddhu and Thakur Prasad Singh were among its regular visitors.

ular visitors.

Kapoor said the establishment was especially popular during the 1970s and 1980s, when people could afford coffee while participating in discussions on politics, literature and society. Its coffee price rose from around Rs 4 to Rs 50 over the years, but its significance extended far beyond its menu.

Unlike a conventional commercial establishment, the Coffee House operated as a cooperative institution. Retired banker and regular visitor Pallab Mitra said previous closures had prompted citizens to seek its revival.

News at a glance

Pakistan: Over 100-year-old temple demolished in Punjab

LAHORE: An over century old Hindu temple has been demolished reportedly to include its land in a madrassa in Punjab province of Pakistan, officials and minority bodies said on Monday.

Local people, minority bodies and a political party said a group of religious zealots demolished the temple to include its land in an adjacent seminary, while the government claimed that the old temple collapsed due to torrential rains. The 100-125-year-old temple was located in Siraj village of Narowal, some 130 kms from Lahore.

Israel, Greece sign multi-billion-dollar weapons deal

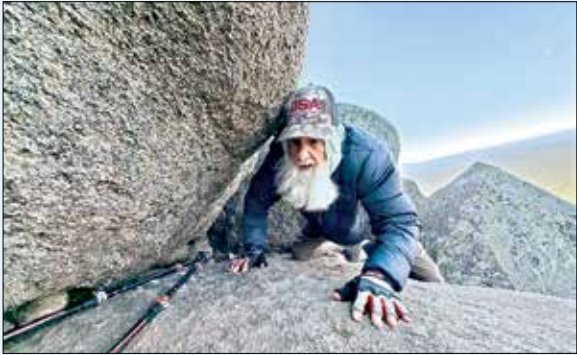
TEL AVIV: Israel signed a multi-billion-dollar weapons deal with Greece, the largest between the two Mediterranean countries, as Israeli defence exports soar.

Israel's Defence Ministry said Monday the nearly 3 billion Euro (USD 3.5 billion) defence export deal. "Israel and Greece share common strategic interests and face shared regional challenges. At a time when actors with hegemonic ambitions are seeking to expand their influence and undermine stability in the region," said Defence Minister.

Colombia's Prez: Soldiers killed key dissident leader

BOGOTA: A key leader of the dissident factions of the defunct Revolutionary Armed Forces of Colombia who operated in a volatile area in the country's southwest region was killed Sunday during a military operation, said President Abelardo de la Espriella.

The president said the death of a man known as "Felipe" or "Arcadio" was a "crushing blow" to the dissident faction led by a man who goes by "Iván Mordisco." De La Espriella posted a video on X presumably.



Dale Sanders, 91, climbs a section of Mt. Katahdin on Monday, in Baxter State Park in Piscataquis PTI

Briefs

School starts soon in Lebanon

TYRE: Eleven-year-old Fatima Khashab helps her mother tidy the small area where their family sleeps, in a row of makeshift living quarters in a school gymnasium.

About 200 families are sheltering in the school in Lebanon's southern coastal city of Tyre. Most are from villages farther south that have been destroyed in the latest war between Israel and the Iran-backed Lebanese militant group Hezbollah or are occupied by Israeli forces, like Fatima's hometown of Mansouri.

The school year will start on Sept. 15, but thousands of displaced people still shelter in public schools.

Pak PM reaches Kyrgyzstan

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif on Monday reached Kyrgyzstan for a three-day visit during which he will attend the Shanghai Cooperation Summit (SCO) and hold bilateral talks.

He is visiting the country at the invitation of President Sadyr Nurgozhoevich Zhaparov, according to an official statement by the foreign office.

"The visit will include participation in the SCO Council of Heads of State meeting, as well as bilateral engagements in the Kyrgyz Republic," the foreign office said.

Policeman killed in blast in Pakistan

PESHAWAR: One policeman was killed and six injured when their vehicle was targeted with an improvised explosive device in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province of Pakistan on Monday, police said.

The police mobile vehicle was on its way from Banda Police Station towards Dargah in Karak district to conduct a search operation when it was hit by the improvised explosive device (IED) planted along the route, according to preliminary reports.

Following the blast, the area was cordoned off and a search operation launched to trace the perpetrators.

'A TEAM FROM SOUTH KOREA HAS ALSO BEEN MOBILISED'

Nepal seeks more global support for tunnel rescue, freezers, forensics

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, August 31

Nepal has sought additional international support, including specialised equipment and technical assistance for tunnel rescue and forensic work, as rescue operations continued after the floods that have killed hundreds and left thousands missing.

During a press briefing in Kathmandu on Monday, Nepal's foreign ministry spokesperson Lok Bahadur Chhetri said the country had sought essential non-food items and services such as freezers, DNA testing kits and LiDAR from the US, relief-specific items like DVI from Singapore, and belly bridges and high-capacity drones from China and Singapore.

So far, Nepal has received airtight bags for the management of bodies, while more are also being delivered.

A team of 18 forensic experts from India specialising in DNA analysis has been in Nepal since August 29.

Chhetri said Nepali



A Nepal Army helicopter hovers near the ground as security personnel unload supplies at a military base, Nuwakot district on Monday PTI

agencies are working with specialised technical teams from India and China on tunnel rescue operations. A team from South Korea has also been mobilised, officials said.

According to the Nepalese Ministry of Foreign Affairs, coordination to

mobilise a DVI team from Singapore is underway.

Nepal has received rescue support from India, China, Japan, the United States, the United Arab Emirates, South Korea and other countries and development partners.

"Items in this regard

include bridge units, freezers, generator sets, solar lamps, DNA testing kits, bridge units, emergency relief equipment as well as tents, blankets, sleeping bags, food packets and medicines," Chhetri said.

Likewise, relief materials have been received

KEY POINTS

- » So far, Nepal has received airtight bags for the management of bodies, while more are also being delivered
- » A team of 18 forensic experts from India specialising in DNA analysis has been in Nepal since August 29

from India, China, the UAE and other countries. More supplies are coming from the UAE, Myanmar, the US, Qatar, the UK, Australia, South Korea, Japan, New Zealand, Malaysia, Singapore, Bangladesh, Pakistan and other friendly countries, and international organisations and partners such as the UN, WHO, WFP and UNICEF, he said.

"We have also received generous pledges of financial assistance from our friends and partners from across the globe. We deeply value support and assistance in this difficult time, and we are truly grateful," Chhetri added.

Nepal floods expose risks to hydropower in warming Himalayas

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, August 31

Workers shovelled thick mud from a flood-ravaged power station in central Nepal, trying to revive a key node that supplies electricity to more than

20,000 people. But as they cleared debris from equipment buried by last week's catastrophic floods, there was hope the plant would not simply be rebuilt in the same place, beside the river that destroyed it.

In Nepal, up to 900

workers are unaccounted for from a dozen hydropower projects, according to the Independent Power Producers' Association, Nepal, with hundreds believed trapped in tunnels. In Nepal and China combined, over 900 people

have died and 4,700 are missing.

The loss of hydropower infrastructure is estimated to have taken 700 megawatts offline -- about 10 per cent of the country's power capacity. Once the immediate

aftermath of the disaster is dealt with, the question of how to restore power, roads, bridges, schools and health facilities quickly without rebuilding the same vulnerabilities should be on top of Nepalese authorities' minds.

UAE intercepts Iranian drone over territorial waters

The attack comes after US and Iran exchanged fire on weekend

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Beirut, August 31

An Iranian drone was intercepted early Monday over the United Arab Emirates' territorial waters, the Defence Ministry said. The attack followed an exchange of fire between Iran and the United States over the weekend, which was the first significant military action in the war for more than a month.

Iran fired a drone at the United Arab Emirates on Monday, which the UAE's Defence Ministry said was intercepted over its territorial waters.

After more than a month with no significant fighting, the US attacked rocket launchers on an Iranian

AFTER MORE THAN A MONTH WITH NO SIGNIFICANT FIGHTING, THE US ATTACKED ROCKET LAUNCHERS ON AN IRANIAN ISLAND ON SUNDAY

island on Sunday, saying they were preparing to launch mines into the Strait of Hormuz.

Iran responded by launching missiles at US sites in Jordan, all of which were intercepted.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said that his country wasn't seeking war, but that "we will respond decisively to aggressors."

Congo reports over 6,000 confirmed Ebola cases

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Bunia, August 31

Congo's authorities said Monday that the fastest-growing Ebola outbreak in history has topped 6,000 cases with 2,911 deaths.

More than 1,360 people have recovered from the virus, in what authorities said was an "encouraging" development. The outbreak in eastern Congo is spreading under extremely difficult conditions, fuelled by insecurity, displacement, a health workers' strike and intense population movements. The situation is particularly concerning at displacement sites, where residents already live in extremely precarious conditions.

Trump still teases 3rd presidential run

But the US President's talking more and more about life after 2028

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Bunia, August 31

President Donald Trump has frequently suggested he wants to seek a third term, posting about mounting another campaign, donning 2028 caps and discussing ways to make it happen -- even as he's acknowledged the Constitution prohibits it.

But lately, Trump has begun showing signs that even he doesn't really believe another run will happen.

During recent speeches, the Republican president has begun describing life after the White House when his term ends in January 2029, predicting he'll be at home and agonizing as his successor claims credit for his accomplishments.

"Your next president is going to say, What a great job I did," Trump told an



US President Donald Trump

event on Long Island, New York, this month. "He'll be sitting around, watching television. A real stiff. Unless you vote Republican, of course."

A sitting president talking about becoming a former one is always politically fraught. But with midterm elections now just nine weeks away, Trump is approaching the point of his presidency where there will be more and more

reminders that his power will soon wane.

Being willing to say he's contemplating a White House without him marks a notable shift for Trump. Going back to his first term and from virtually the moment he won a second, he's left the door open to staying put for more than eight years.

"He is all over the place," said Brian Kalt, a Michigan State University

constitutional law professor. "And what that does is, it allows him to point to his own words to support any number of mutually exclusive things."

Trump can say, "'Oh yeah, I made it clear that I wasn't gonna run,'" Kalt said. "Or, if he decides that he will, he could say, 'Well, you know, I never said I wouldn't.'"

The White House dismissed suggestions that Trump's thoughts are increasingly turning to the clock running out on his presidency -- and the legacy he'll leave behind. Spokesperson Olivia Wales said he "is fighting every day" to deliver on promises to reduce violent crime, crack down on the U. S-Mexico border and lower prescription drug prices. "The only legacy President Trump is concerned with is making America greater than ever before," Wales said.

THE SCHEME COVERS SIX PILLARS & 10 CATEGORIES IN ALL

Govt notifies ₹1.27L cr Semicon 2.0, outlines eligibility and incentives

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 31

The government on Monday notified the Rs 1.27-lakh-crore Semicon 2.0 programme, spelling out eligibility and incentives across the semiconductor value chain, including 40 per cent fiscal support for silicon wafer fabs with a minimum investment of Rs 20,000 crore, and sweeteners for chip design.

India's bold pitch to woo global investors and foster startups working on cutting-edge chip design comes at a time when semiconductors have emerged as a critical strategic resource globally, with the AI boom driving unprecedented demand for advanced chips and memory.

At the same time, growing concerns over supply-chain vulnerabilities and shifting geopolitics have pushed global players to expand semiconductor capacities and reduce dependence on concentrated production hubs.

"In the coming years, close to 10 per cent of



Union Minister of Electronics and IT Ashwini Vaishnaw

the global semiconductor industry's market is expected to be in India," Union Minister of Electronics & IT Ashwini Vaishnaw said.

While the Semicon 2.0 scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet on July 15, 2026, Monday's notification spells out the exact contours of the new programme, detailing how the Rs 1,27,500-crore outlay will be implemented, how incentives will be structured, and the eligibility thresholds for various categories. Design forms the first of the scheme's six pillars, with the government laying out a multi-pronged support framework span-

KEY POINTS

- » While the Semicon 2.0 scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet on July 15, 2026, Monday's notification spells out the exact contours of the new programme
- » The notification outlines the implementation of the Rs 1,27,500-crore outlay, the structure of incentives and eligibility thresholds for various categories
- » For commercial chip design, Semicon 2.0 supports India-headquartered companies owned or controlled by Indian citizens or OCLs, with IP and design files required to remain in India

ning chips for strategic and critical infrastructure, commercial chip design, and incentives for deployment of indigenously-designed chips and IPs - all geared to build a self-reliant and competitive chip design ecosystem in India.

Within design, the first category targets strategic priorities, covering IPs, chips, System-on-Chip (SoC) and modules for critical and national infrastructure. Eligible companies must be incorporated and headquartered in India, have a significant domestic operational and manpower presence, and be Indian-owned and controlled.

They can participate

independently or through consortiums, with fiscal and infrastructure support determined through competitive bidding under CDAC-issued request for proposals. The identification of the chips will be done by a high-level expert committee chaired by the Principal Scientific Adviser (PSA) and the National Security Adviser (NSA).

IP rights will be jointly owned by the applicant and C-DAC, and fiscal support will be disbursed based on RFP terms and conditions.

For commercial chip design, Semicon 2.0 supports India-headquartered companies owned or controlled by Indian citizens

or OCLs, with IP and design files required to remain in India. Incentives include access to EDA tools, wafer fabrication, IP cores and validation infrastructure for design infrastructure support.

For product design-linked incentive, startups and MSMEs can receive seed funding of up to Rs 15 crore, or 50 per cent of project cost, and equity co-investment (beyond Rs 15 crore), while other eligible firms can access royalty financing or equity co-investment.

Separately, under the deployment-linked incentive, new IPs, chips and SoCs with no prior sales can receive a 9 per cent reimbursement on net sales for five years, capped at Rs 30 crore per application and Rs 120 crore per company.

The scheme, notified by the Ministry of Electronics & IT, covers six pillars & 10 categories in all, spanning chip design, semiconductor equipment and materials, fabrication, packaging, research and development, and talent creation.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 31

Private equity and venture capital funds' investments in India increased 3 per cent year-on-year to \$4.1 billion in July, as per a report released on Monday.

The investments were up from \$4 billion recorded in July last year, and 52 per cent higher than \$2.7 billion invested in the preceding month, the report by the consultant EY and industry grouping IVCA said.

The number of deals in July 2026 at 111 was 7 per cent lower than the 119 transactions in July 2025, indicating a jump in ticket sizes, and were much higher than the 80 deals in June 2026, the report said.

"India's macroeconomic fundamentals remain supportive of investment activity. With significant dry powder available across PE/VC (Private equity and venture capital) funds, deal-making is expected to accelerate further as geopolitical conditions stabilise," the



consultancy firm's partner Vivek Soni said.

July 2026 recorded 10 large deals totalling \$2.8 billion or around 68 per cent of the total activity, it said, adding that Brookfield's \$600 million bet in Lumara was the highest.

Buyout investments accounted for the largest share of PE/VC activity in July 2026, with \$1.4 billion deployed, which was a 176 per cent jump from the \$511 million in July 2025 while credit investments ranked second, witnessing over \$880 million getting invested.

Investments into startups jumped 90 per cent on-year to \$805 million

in July 2026, the report noted.

From a sectoral perspective, infrastructure led with \$1.5 billion in investments, followed by financial services at \$649 million and food and agriculture with \$335 million, as per the report.

There were 17 exits worth \$1.6 billion compared to \$9.2 billion across 26 exits in July 2025, the report said, reminding that the year-ago period saw Temasek's \$6.4 billion exit from Schneider Electric.

PE and VC funds raised \$2.5 billion across eight fund raises in July as against \$1.5 billion in the year-ago period.

Briefs

Rupee rises 21 paise to 95.22/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee appreciated by 21 paise to 95.22 against the US dollar on Monday, on possible RBI intervention, as rising crude oil prices weighed on the local unit.

At the interbank forex, the rupee opened at 95.56 and traded in range of 95.11-95.56 during the session. It finally settled for the day at 95.22, higher by 21 paise from its previous close.

HDFC Bank shares end 1.5% lower

NEW DELHI: Shares of HDFC Bank ended 1.5 per cent lower on Monday, paring early gains, after its MD & CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan opted out of being considered for reappointment.

The stock declined 1.53 per cent to Rs 709 on the BSE. During morning trade, the stock had climbed 2.70 per cent to Rs 739.50. At the NSE, the stock edged lower by 1.56 per cent to end at Rs 709 after rising 2.70 per cent in morning deals.

Centre's FY27 fiscal deficit touches 26.8% of full year target at July end

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 31

The central government's fiscal deficit for 2026-27 stood at 26.8 per cent of the full-year target at the end of July, according to data released by the Controller General of Accounts (CGA) on Monday.

The deficit was at 29.9 per cent of Budget Estimates (BE) of 2025-26 for the first four months of the previous financial year.

In absolute terms, the fiscal deficit, or gap between the government's expenditure and revenue, was Rs 4,55,144 crore in the April-July

THE DEFICIT WAS AT 29.9 PER CENT OF BUDGET ESTIMATES (BE) OF 2025-26 FOR THE FIRST FOUR MONTHS OF THE PREVIOUS FINANCIAL YEAR

period of the 2026-27 fiscal year.

The Centre has set a fiscal deficit target of 4.3 per cent of the GDP or Rs 16.96 lakh crore for the current fiscal.

According to the CGA, the Centre's net tax revenue was about Rs 8.45 lakh crore, or 29.5 per cent of the correspond-

ing Budget Estimates of 2026-27 of total receipts, up to July 2026.

In the corresponding period of the previous fiscal year, the net tax revenue was at 23.3 per cent of that year's BE.

The data on monthly accounts showed that the total expenditure during the first four months was at about Rs 17.62 lakh crore, or 32.9 per cent of Budget Estimates. In the year-ago period, it was at 30.9 per cent of BE.

The Centre transferred Rs 3,72,354 crore to state governments as devolution of share of taxes during the period, which is Rs 56,190 crore lower than the previous year.

LIC to celebrate 70th anniversary today

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 31

The Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), the country's leading life insurer, will celebrate its 70th Anniversary on Tuesday, September 1, 2026, marking seven decades of service since its establishment on September 1, 1956.

Founded to expand life insurance coverage and provide financial protection at a reasonable cost, LIC has retained its market leadership, with a 65.16% market share in policies



LIC HAS RETAINED ITS MARKET LEADERSHIP, WITH A 65.16% MARKET SHARE IN POLICIES IN FY 2025-26

and 56.66% in First Year Premium Income in FY 2025-26. Its total AUM increased by 5.08% to Rs 57.29 Lakh Crore.

Despite the entry of private players, LIC remains India's largest life insurer, supported by its extensive branch, agent and digital networks. It offers

life insurance, pension and market-linked products. A key milestone was its IPO in May 2022, followed by listing on the NSE and BSE.

LIC's Golden Jubilee Foundation (GJF), established in 2006, has disbursed Rs 303 crore under 1045 projects across the

country and awarded 41,776 scholarships amounting to Rs 105.27 crore to needy students.

The corporation has also strengthened its digital platforms, including the My LIC App, to improve customer convenience and service delivery.

As LIC marks its 70th Anniversary, it reaffirmed its commitment to policyholders, shareholders, employees, agents and other stakeholders, guided by its ethos, "Yogakshemam Vahamyaham - Your welfare is our responsibility."

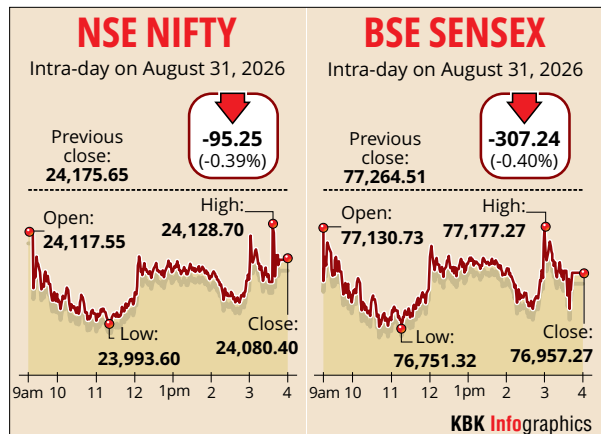
PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 31

Stock markets closed lower on Monday amid selling in utilities, IT, and FMCG shares, as renewed tensions in West Asia pushed crude oil higher and fanned fears of a higher-interest-rate environment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex declined 307.24 points, or 0.40 per cent, to settle at 76,957.27 with 20 of its constituents ending lower and 10 with gains.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 95.25 points, or 0.39 per cent, to end at 24,080.40.

Weak trends in global markets and foreign fund



outflows dented investor sentiment, analysts said.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, Adani Ports fell the most by 4.11 per cent, followed by HDFC Bank, ITC,

Bharti Airtel, Infosys, Kotak Mahindra Bank, Trent, Hindustan Unilever and Titan.

Sun Pharma, ICICI Bank, Axis Bank and State Bank of India (SBI) were among

the gainers.

The BSE SmallCap Select index declined 0.40 per cent and MidCap Select index dipped 0.12 per cent.

Among BSE sectoral indices, Utilities tanked 2.64 per cent, Metal (2.42 per cent), Services (1.95 per cent), Commodities (1.52 per cent), Housing Finance (1.33 per cent), Power (1.31 per cent) and FMCG (1.14 per cent).

Financial Services, Private Banks index, Bankex, Top 10 Banks and MidSmall Private Banks ended higher.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 5,039.80 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

HSBC MF's RedHex Hybrid Fund crosses ₹1K crore AUM

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 31

HSBC Mutual Fund's RedHex Hybrid Long-Short Fund, a Specialised Investment Fund (SIF) strategy, has crossed Rs 1,000 crore in AUM (Assets Under Management) within just 2 months of its listing.

Launched in June 2026, the fund has attracted around 1,950 unique folios, reflecting growing investor interest in differentiated investment solutions.

RedHex invests across

fixed income, equity arbitrage, REITs and INVITs to pursue risk-adjusted returns across market cycles.

Kailash Kulkarni, CEO, HSBC Mutual Fund, said the Rs 1,000 crore AUM milestone reflects evolving investor preferences for greater flexibility and diversification while retaining the transparency and discipline of mutual funds.

Shriram Ramanathan, CIO - Fixed Income, HSBC Mutual Fund, said the

fund follows a disciplined approach to asset allocation, credit selection, accrual potential and risk management, while seeking to keep volatility relatively low.

The strategy aims to generate regular income in a tax efficient manner through diversified asset allocation, active portfolio management and risk controls.

It is benchmarked against the NIFTY 50 Hybrid Composite Debt 50:50 Index.

JSW MG Motor India appoints Parth Jindal as its Chairman

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, August 31

The Board of Directors of JSW MG Motor India Pvt Ltd appointed Parth Jindal as Chairman of the Company, with immediate effect. Parth has served on the Board of JSW MG Motor India since the formation of the joint venture, and has been closely involved in shaping the Company's product strategy, manufacturing expansion and localisation programme.

Parth Jindal is Managing

Director of JSW Cement, Managing Director of JSW Paints, Chairman of JSW Dulux Ltd, Chairman of JSW MG Motor India, and a Director on the Board of JSW Energy. He is also the Founder of JSW Sports and Chairman and Co-Owner of the Delhi Capitals.

JSW MG Motor India Pvt Ltd is a joint venture between JSW Group and SAIC Motor, it combines JSW's deep understanding of the Indian market with SAIC's global automotive expertise.

Lakshadweep fisheries outreach to boost Blue Economy

Vice President CP Radhakrishnan also released 'Mission Rangen Machhli 2031'

MPOST BUREAU
Agatti, August 31

The Department of Fisheries, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying, organised a Fisheries Outreach Programme at Agatti, Lakshadweep, on August 31, 2026, focusing on strengthening FFPOs and fisheries cooperatives and sustainably harnessing tuna, seaweed and ornamental fisheries resources.

Vice President CP Radhakrishnan described Lakshadweep as a "priceless

maritime asset" and highlighted its 4,200 sq. km lagoon and nearly 4 lakh sq. km Exclusive Economic Zone.

He said the islands have fisheries potential of over 1 lakh tonnes, including about 94,000 tonnes of tuna and tuna-like species.

"Conservation of marine resources and adherence to responsible fishing practices are essential for ensuring long-term prosperity of the fisheries sector," he said. He also released "Mission Rangen



Machhli 2031".

Union Minister for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry &

Dairying Rajiv Ranjan Singh said the programme reflects the government's commit-

ment to Lakshadweep's fishing communities and a roadmap for improving incomes, infrastructure, safety, value addition and market access. "Lakshadweep's vast untapped high value tuna resources" must be sustainably harnessed, he said.

India's fish production rose from 95.7 lakh tonnes in 2013-14 to 197.75 lakh tonnes in 2024-25, while seafood exports reached Rs 73,890 crore in 2025-26.

Minister of State for Fisheries, Animal Hus-

bandry & Dairying Prof. S P Singh Baghel, Administrator of Lakshadweep Praful Khoda Patel and Secretary, Department of Fisheries, Dr. Abhilaksh Likhi, also addressed the event.

Baghel highlighted 575 seaweed cultivation units and 19 recreational fishing units; Patel noted 16 Deep Sea Fishing Vessels sanctioned at about Rs 1.2 crore each; and Likhi highlighted opportunities in tuna, deep-sea fishing, mariculture, seaweed and ornamental fisheries.

News at a glance

Tata-owned IHCL opens 80-key resort in Jim Corbett

NEW DELHI: Tata Group-owned Indian Hotels Company (IHCL), the country's largest hospitality player, on Monday announced the opening of the 80-key Corbett Hideaway, Jim Corbett - IHCL SeleQ-tions resort in Uttarakhand.

Gaurav Pokhariyal, Chief Operating Officer, Full-Service Business, IHCL, said, "Corbett is one of India's most sought-after wildlife destinations, drawing travellers with its natural beauty and thriving ecosystem. The addition of Corbett Hideaway - IHCL SeleQ-tions strengthens our presence in Uttarakhand and furthers our partnership with Leisure Hotels Group."

ITC Infotech to acquire 22.1% stake in Happiest Minds

NEW DELHI: ITC Ltd on Monday said its wholly-owned subsidiary ITC Infotech will acquire a 22.1 per cent stake in Happiest Minds Technologies for around Rs 1,330 crore, paving the way for their merger into a \$1-billion tech giant.

ITC Infotech will acquire 3,36,61,700 shares from promoter Ashok Soota and Ashok Soota Medical Research LLP in two tranches. Post-merger, ITC will hold 73.4 per cent in the combined entity, while Happiest Minds shareholders will own 26.6 per cent. The merged entity will employ over 19,000 professionals and target \$1 billion revenue by FY28.

BoB to recruit 2,482 local bank officers across 20 states

MUMBAI: Bank of Baroda (BoB) on Monday announced plans to recruit 2,482 local bank officers across 20 states and union territories, amid concerns over staff's ability to communicate in regional languages. The junior management recruits will be required to serve their first 12 years in the state of recruitment or until promotion to a specified level.

The lender said state-based deployment will strengthen local language proficiency and market knowledge. Candidates must be graduates, aged 21-30 years, with at least one year's experience as an officer in a scheduled commercial bank.

Uzbekistan becomes 11th nation to accept UPI payments

NEW DELHI: NPCI International and Uzbekistan's National Interbank Processing Centre (NIPC) have partnered to enable UPI payments across Uzbekistan, the finance ministry said. The agreement will allow Indian tourists, business travellers and students to make instant merchant payments by scanning the country's UZQR code using UPI-enabled apps.

NIPL signed the agreement with NIPC, operator of Uzbekistan's HUMO payment system, on August 30, 2026. The initiative follows approvals from the RBI and Central Bank of Uzbekistan. With Uzbekistan, UPI is now accepted in 11 countries.

ONGC to invest ₹1L cr in deepwater exploration over next five years

‘Three new hydrocarbon discoveries were notified in its operated offshore acreage,’ Arun Kumar Singh, Chairman and CEO, ONGC, said

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, August 31

Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) plans to invest around Rs 1 lakh crore over next five years in deepwater and multi-deepwater exploration as it steps up efforts to identify new hydrocarbon resources, while the company reported three new hydrocarbon discoveries in its operated offshore acreage during FY26, Arun Kumar Singh, Chairman and CEO, ONGC, said on Monday.

In his Chairman's Speech at ONGC's 33rd Annual General Meeting (AGM), Singh said, "Three new hydrocarbon discoveries were notified in its operated offshore acreage."

Singh said testing concluded during FY26 established 55 wells as hydrocarbon-bearing, including wells drilled in previous years.

During FY26, ONGC acquired 957.25 lakh line kilometres (LKM) of 2D seismic data and 4,631.04 square kilometres (SKM) of 3D seismic data.

The company has cumulatively drilled 79 exploratory wells and made 13 discoveries in its Open



Arun Kumar Singh, Chairman & CEO, ONGC

TESTING CONCLUDED DURING FY26 ESTABLISHED 55 WELLS AS HYDROCARBON-BEARING, INCLUDING WELLS DRILLED IN PREVIOUS YEARS

Acreage Licensing Policy (OALP) blocks, Singh said.

Reserve accretion in 2P terms from ONGC-operated areas in India stood at 44.01 million tonnes of oil equivalent (MMTOE), resulting in a Reserve Replacement Ratio (RRR) of 1.17.

On deepwater exploration, Singh said in his speech, "India's next major discoveries are likely to come from deepwater, and the company has taken up that responsibility in full measure." He said ONGC

KEY POINTS

- » The company has cumulatively drilled 79 exploratory wells and made 13 discoveries in its Open Acreage Licensing Policy (OALP) blocks, Singh said
- » On deepwater exploration, Singh said in his speech, 'India's next major discoveries are likely to come from deepwater, and the company has taken up that responsibility in full measure'
- » Singh said ONGC expected to drill around seven deepwater wells this year and 10 next year, taking the planned drilling to 17 wells over two years

had mobilised specialist knowledge and planned double-crew deepwater drilling activity over the next four years.

The company has also floated a tender for exploratory wells in the ultra-deepwater domain.

Singh said ONGC had awarded AWDP-1 on January 27, 2026, the first strategic well under the government-approved scheme.

The chairman also highlighted the redevelopment

of Mumbai High. He said ONGC had placed the Notice of Award for the Redevelopment Phase-I Scheme with bp on December 26, 2025.

The scheme is expected to deliver cumulative incremental production of 2.699 million tonnes (MMT) of oil and 2.806 billion cubic metres (BCM) of natural gas by March 2040, Singh said.

He said Mumbai High had been producing for five decades and was witnessing gradual decline, requiring advanced recovery methods, disciplined reservoir management and global best practices.

During the Q&A session following the speech, Singh said the scale of investment required for deepwater and multi-deepwater exploration could be around Rs 1 lakh crore over five years.

He also said the government had decided to provide around Rs 84,000 crore for deepwater exploration over the next three to four years.

Singh said ONGC expected to drill around seven deepwater wells this year and 10 next year, taking the planned drilling to 17 wells over two years. With more seismic data available, the com-

pany could eventually drill around 20 wells on its own.

"Our reservoirs are old. And what we withdraw from reservoir, we need to find new reservoirs," Singh said during the Q&A, explaining the importance of maintaining a reserve replacement ratio above one.

On the economics of deepwater exploration, Singh said that if the discovered pool size was sufficiently large, an oil price above \$40 per barrel could make such projects viable.

"If the pool size is good, FPSO you put, anything above 40 is okay," he said.

Singh also said ONGC expected oil and gas to remain dominant in the global energy mix over the next five to seven years, while the company would continue developing its renewable energy portfolio.

ONGC produced 20.599 MMT of crude oil and 19.066 BCM of natural gas during FY26, including its share from joint ventures.

The company is targeting 10 GW of renewable energy capacity by 2030 and Net Zero Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions by 2038, Singh said.

IOC boosted LPG production by 30% amid Hormuz disruption

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 31

State-owned Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) ramped up liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) production by nearly 30 per cent and kept its refineries operating above 100 per cent utilisation as disruptions to maritime trade through the Strait of Hormuz threatened India's energy supplies, its chairman said on Monday.

The company also diversified crude sourcing, realigned refinery operations and secured alternative supplies as the escalation of conflict in West Asia disrupted global energy markets, IOC chairman Arvind Singh Sahney said in his address to the company's 67th annual general meeting.

"For IndianOil, the priority during this unprecedented crisis has remained crystal clear - to maintain continuity of energy supplies despite constrained sourcing options and volatile international markets," he said.

India imports more than 88 per cent of its crude oil requirement, while about 45 per cent of its crude imports and nearly 90 per cent of LPG imports are linked to the Strait of Hormuz, underscoring the exposure of the world's third-largest oil consumer to disruptions in the strategic waterway.

"With close monitoring and guidance from the Min-



istry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, our teams have responded with agility - diversifying crude sourcing, realigning refinery operations and strengthening supply-chain coordination to secure alternate supplies, optimise cargo movements and rebalance products across regions," he said.

IOC used 24-hour control rooms, daily reviews and real-time market monitoring to respond to supply gaps, he said, adding that the company had maintained product availability despite a "significant shift away from Middle Eastern crude grades."

"Despite a significant shift away from Middle Eastern crude grades, our refineries operated above 100 per cent utilisation, LPG production was ramped up by nearly 30 per cent within a short period, and our gas business maintained supplies to priority sectors while securing additional LNG from diversified geographies," he said.

The disruption came as

IOC was reporting record operating performance. For the year ended March 2026, the company posted a standalone net profit of Rs 36,802 crore on turnover of about Rs 8.86 lakh crore, with aggregate sales exceeding 105 million tonnes across petroleum products, natural gas and petrochemicals.

Its refineries processed a record 75.45 million tonnes of crude during the year, while liquid pipeline throughput reached a record 102.52 million tonnes and domestic petroleum-product sales rose to an all-time high of 88.97 million tonnes.

The momentum continued into the first quarter of the current financial year.

IOC processed a record 19.17 million tonnes of crude at 109.4 per cent capacity utilisation, while pipeline throughput reached a quarterly record of 28.55 million tonnes.

Its domestic petroleum-product market share rose to 43.1 per cent, the chairman said.

Tata Advanced Systems, Javelin JV ink pact for missile production

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 31

Tata Advanced Systems Ltd and Javelin Joint Venture, a partnership between Raytheon and Lockheed Martin, have inked a MoU to explore co-production of Javelin All Up Round (AUR) missiles in India.

The partnership envisages a dedicated final assembly and integration facility in India, along with component manufacturing capabilities.

Sub-assembly kits will be manufactured at Lockheed Martin's Troy facility in Alabama, while guidance electronics will come from Raytheon's Tucson facility before being shipped to India for final assembly.

The initiative aims to strengthen India's defence manufacturing ecosystem, support technology and knowledge transfer, create high-tech jobs and enhance supply-chain resilience.

Tata Advanced Systems CEO and MD Sukaran Singh said local assembly would strengthen self-reliance and ensure timely access to the Javelin system for the Indian Armed Forces.

The Javelin JV has produced over 55,000 missiles & over 12,000 reusable Command Launch Units.

NSE records CAS turnover of ₹39,718 crore in first month

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, August 31

The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) on Monday recorded Rs 39,718 crore (approximately \$4.2 billion) turnover in the Closing Auction Session (CAS), with a 99.9 per cent market share, on the first index rebalancing day since CAS was introduced.

CAS accounted for 22 per cent of NSE's cash market turnover, with more than 98,000 unique investors participating. Turnover



was around 42 times the previous session.

The session also completed its first month, with cumulative CAS turnover reaching Rs 63,000 crore (approximately \$6.6 billion) and a 98.2 per cent market share. The sharp rise on

Monday was driven by the MSCI August 2026 Index Review, which took effect at the close of trading.

Index funds, ETFs and other passive investors typically see higher trading volumes during rebalancing as they realign portfolios at closing prices.

NSE said the strong participation reflects growing acceptance of CAS among institutional, retail and other market participants as a transparent mechanism for closing price discovery.

NCLT forms 5-member bench to decide Subhash Chandra insolvency case after lack of consensus

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 31

The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) has constituted a five-member bench to decide the personal insolvency case against Zee Group founder Subhash Chandra after a two-member bench found no majority opinion on his repayment plan.

The case involves Chandra's proposal to pay Rs 6.25 crore against admitted claims of Rs 22,006.57 crore.

NCLT President Justice



(retired) Anupinder Singh Grewal will head the special bench, which includes Judicial Members Bachu Venkat Baram Das and Mahendra Khandelwal, and Technical Members Atul Chaturvedi and Ravindra Chaturvedi. It will hear the matter at 10.15 AM on September 1.

On August 31, the two-member bench comprising Judicial Member Ashok Kumar Bhardwaj and Technical Member Reena Sinha Puri held that no final order could be passed based on third member Nilesh Sharma's August 25 opinion.

Bhardwaj had favoured approving the plan for supporting creditors while allowing dissenting banks and financial institutions to pursue recovery. Puri rejected the plan, citing serious procedural defects.

Sharma had subsequently favoured approval

but excluded claims filed on behalf of 960 individuals by Anil Kumar and 300 individuals by Sunil Jain, directing redistribution of the allocated amount among eligible creditors.

Meanwhile, LIC Housing Finance has challenged Sharma's order before the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta sought an urgent hearing, arguing that allowing the order to continue would defeat the purpose of the IBC. The appeal is also listed for September 1.

Adani urges broader frameworks for infra ratings

Adani said India needs 'wider lenses', to evaluate infrastructure

AGENCIES
Mumbai, August 31

Billionaire Gautam Adani on Monday urged Indian credit-rating agencies to adopt broader frameworks for assessing infrastructure projects, saying conventional models can understate their wider economic and strategic value.

Speaking at the CareEdge Group Annual Summit in Mumbai, Adani said India needs "wider lenses", not lower credit standards, to evaluate



Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani

infrastructure that creates new markets and industrial ecosystems.

He proposed a framework for "integrated platform infrastructure" that considers ecosystem effects, strategic resilience

CLOSER LOOK

- » He proposed a framework for 'integrated platform infrastructure' that considers ecosystem effects, strategic resilience & adjacency value alongside leverage, cash flows, execution risks
- » The Adani Group Chairman cited Mundra, Vizhinjam and Khavda as examples of infrastructure creating wider capabilities

and adjacency value alongside leverage, cash flows and execution risks.

Adani cited Mundra port, Vizhinjam port and the Khavda renewable-energy project as examples of infrastructure creating

capabilities beyond their standalone assets. He said Khavda's clean power could support data centres, AI and advanced manufacturing, while Vizhinjam could strengthen India's position in global shipping.

SC trashes PIL on ethanol disclosure at fuel pumps

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 31

The Supreme Court on Monday dismissed a PIL seeking mandatory and uniform labelling on fuel pump nozzles and invoices disclosing the exact ethanol percentage in petrol.

A bench of Justices MM Sundresh and PB Varale said it would not entertain the plea under Article 32 and asked petitioner Narendra Kumar Goswami to approach the jurisdictional high court.

Attorney General R Venkataramani, appear-

ing for the Centre, called the plea "proxy litigation", noting that a similar petition had earlier been dismissed.

Goswami argued that consumers have a right to know the fuel composition and sought disclosure of ethanol content on receipts.

His plea also sought a vehicle-wise E20 compatibility database, an independent expert committee to assess E20's impact on vehicles, fuel efficiency, engine life and emissions, and a national consumer disclosure protocol for ethanol-blended petrol.



PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my client Sh. VIMAL KUMAR JAIN S/o Sh. Veersen Jain R/o House No.49/2-D, New No.460, Ground Floor, Halkara Kuan, Jwala Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032, has disowned his son Sh. RAJAT JAIN S/o Sh. Vimal Kumar Jain R/o House No.49/2-D, New No.460, Ground Floor, Halkara Kuan, Jwala Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032, and severed all his relations social and financial with them due to their disobedience. He has debarred them from inheriting his properties movable and immovable. He shall not be responsible for any of their acts, deeds and things. Anybody dealing with them shall be doing so at his/her own risk.

Sharad Chandra Gupta
Advocate
Seat No-A-14, S.D.M Court Compound
Seelampur, Delhi-110053

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

I, POONAM TULSYAN
W/o Shri Amritam Jalan,
R/o B-3/11, Safdarjung Enclave, New Delhi 110029 have changed my name to POONAM JALAN for all future purposes.

TENDER NOTICE

THE ROYAL EMBASSY OF SAUDI ARABIA, NEW DELHI INVITES PROPOSALS FROM COMPETENT SECURITY COMPANIES FOR PROVIDING GUARDING SERVICES TO PREMISES OF THE EMBASSY, THE AMBASSADOR'S RESIDENCE AND THE SAUDI SCHOOL.

Interested companies may collect the tender form, from Gate No. 2 Monday to Friday between 9:00 a.m. to 4 p.m.

EP-30, Chandragupta Marg, Chanakyapuri New Delhi-21
Tel. No.: 011-24102000 (Extn. 1032-1033-1041)
email : inemb@mofa.gov.sa

Submission of bidding (sealed envelope) will be considered within 30 days from : 01.09.2026 to 30.09.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Nilufa Khatoon, S/o Tinku Sheikh, R/o H.No. A-232, Resettlement Colony, Sector-26, Rohini, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 1170/2023, U/s 380/454/411/34 IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Nilufa Khatoon cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Nilufa Khatoon has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Nilufa Khatoon accused of FIR No. 1170/2023, U/s 380/454/411/34 IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.10.2026.

By Order - Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrat First Class-05 (North)
DPI/12227/ON/2026 Room No. 114, Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON (SEE SECTION 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) Rohit Jain S/o Baldeep Kumar Jain R/o I-1/25, Budh Vihar, Phase-1, Rohini, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CT No. 4215/2019 & 2851/2019, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Model Town, Delhi and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) Rohit Jain can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) Rohit Jain has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) Rohit Jain of case CT No. 4215/2019 & 2851/2019, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Model Town, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated 12.10.2026.

By Order
Sh. Aakash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 213, 2nd Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/11927/NW/2026 (Court Matter)

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY LTD				
No.02-03/CE (S&P)/NIT/4146		Raipur, dt. 31.08.2026		
NOTICE INVITING TENDER				
Sealed tenders, for the following items are invited:-				
Tender Specification No.	Item	Approx. tender value (₹ in Lakhs)	Purchase /download of Tender document fee with GST (₹)	Last date of tender submission
02-03/CE (S&P) /968	Procurement of 5KV Digital Insulation Tester.	162.00	5,000/-	30.09.2026
02-03/CE (S&P) /969	Loose Relays:- (i) Set of 3 Over current + Earth Fault (Numerical type) (ii) Master trip relay	342.38	5,000/-	15.10.2026
IMPORTANT: (I) Please note that any Notice for Corrigendum or extension of due date of tender opening shall not be published in newspapers. It will be displayed only on official website of the company. (II) The tenders will be processed through e-bidding module of SAP-SRM. Bidders are advised to visit our website www.cseb.gov.in/cspddl for viewing detailed instructions regarding submission of offer through SAP-SRM. (III) Date of "Pre-Bid" meeting to be held will be intimated separately on our website. For details, visit our web site: www.cseb.gov.in/cspddl .				
SAVE ELECTRICITY		samvad 48894/1		CHIEF ENGINEER (S&P)

UJVNL Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

TENDER NOTICE Date: 31.08.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation), Khodri Power Station, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No: 10/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27: Repair/Overhauling of 01 No. 800 KVA Station Auxiliary Transformer, Condition Assessment of 03 Nos. 500 KVA Unit Auxiliary Transformers (UATs), and Procurement of Essential Electrical Spares at Khodri Power Station.

Tender No: 11/EE(Gen)/Khodri/2026-27: Various Miscellaneous O&M Works in Generators of Unit 1, 2, 3 & 4 at Khodri Power Station.

Estimated cost: Rs. 21,95,625/- GST extra & Rs. 15,25,559/- GST extra
Date of availability of bid document on website: 01.09.2026, 10:00 hrs.

Last date for submission of tender: 21.09.2026 up to 16:00 hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

Executive Engineer (Generation)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Sunny, S/o Jai Singh, R/o 203, Village Niothi, Nangloi, West Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 1748/2022, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Sunny cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Sunny has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Sunny accused of FIR No. 1748/2022, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.10.2026.

By Order - Sh. Anshul Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04, West
DP/12086/OD/2026 Room No. 268, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely Rahul Goel S/o Jai Prakesh Goel R/O BN-101 4" Floor Shalimar Bagh, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 875/22 U/s 3(1) DPDP Act PS Shalimar Bagh, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Rahul Goel cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Rahul Goel has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Rahul Goel accused of FIR No. 875/22 U/s 3(1) DPDP Act PS Shalimar Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 31.10.2026.

By Order
Ms. Upasana Satija
DP/12235/NW/2026 CJM, Room No. 108 157 Floor Rohini Courts, Delhi (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely Alzuber @ Zuber S/o Mohd Farman R/o- B-44 Ranjeet Singh Marg Gandhi Market Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 402/2024 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC PS I P Estate, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Alzuber @ Zuber cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Alzuber @ Zuber has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Alzuber @ Zuber accused of FIR No. 402/2024 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC PS I P Estate, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 03.11.2026.

By Order
Ms. Preeti
DP/12126/CD/2026 JMFC-03, Room No. 150 Tis Hazari Court, Delhi (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Ashok Kumar Rana, S/o: Ram Singh, R/o: H.No. 1, VPO Gewra, Delhi, Also at: B-44, Gali No. 2, New Usmanpur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 165/2023, U/s: 406/419/420/467/468/471 IPC, Police Station Connaught Place, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Ashok Kumar Rana cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Ashok Kumar Rana has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Ashok Kumar Rana of Police Station Connaught Place, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 05.11.2026.

By Order
Ms. Charan Salwan
DP/12259/NDD/2026 JMFC-01, Room No. 21, Patiala House Courts, New Delhi (Court Matter)

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

(SIGNAL & TELECOMMUNICATION WORKSHOP)

PODANUR

E-Tender

For and on behalf of the president of India, The Chief Workshop Manager, Signal and Telecommunication Workshop, Podanur, Coimbatore-641023, invites E-Tender for the following works as per Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) in the portal www.ireps.gov.in Tenderers/Contractors intending to apply for the tender needs to get enrolled in the portal www.ireps.gov.in and only online tenders will be accepted. The Bid Security deposit should be made through online payment gateway or through available modes as mentioned in Tender document.

TENDER NOTICE No.SGW-S-203-UFSBI-679606-26 dated.28.08.2026

1	Name of work	Manufacturing, supply, installation, testing, and commissioning of UFSBI cabinets, UFSBI electronics, and associated accessories for Automatic Signaling / MSDAC works over Chennai Division
2	Approximate cost of the work	₹ 12,33,64,829.88/- Including GST @ 18%
3	Earnest money to be deposited	₹ 24,67,300/-
4	Completion period of work	90 Days
5	Date and time of closing of tender.	Before 15.00 Hrs of 18.09.2026
6	Date and time of opening of Technical Bid (Packet-1)	After 15.00 Hrs. of 18.09.2026
7	Website particulars	www.ireps.gov.in

For further details, visit office of the Chief Workshop Manager, Signal and Telecommunication workshop, Podanur, Coimbatore-641023.

**Production Engineer,
For Chief Workshop Manager,
S&T Workshop, Podanur.**

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

PUBLIC NOTICE

Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice that VINOD KUMAR / TRIPTI KUMARI (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBDEL00005151568 located at FLAT NO C1/704, 7TH FLOOR, SHREE VARDHMAN GARDENIA, SECTOR 10 , SONIPAT 131001. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement.

The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated Aug 27, 2026, informing that SHREE VARDHMAN DEVELOPERS PRIVATE LIMITED, has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.

Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: September 01, 2026 For ICICI Bank Limited
Place : Delhi/ NCR Sd-

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

PUBLIC NOTICE

Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice that Abhishek Kumar/ Komal Sharan (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBGHZ00005193256 located at Flat No C2/701, 7th Floor, Tower No C2, Shree Vardhman Gardenia, Sector 10 Sonipat, Haryana Sonipat- 131001. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement.

The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated August 27, 2026, informing that Shree Vardhman Developers Private Limited, has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.

Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: September 01, 2026 For ICICI Bank Limited
Place : Delhi/ NCR Sd-

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Yuvraj Sharma, S/o: Rajkumar Sharma, R/o: Flat No. 1201, (9201), Tower-9, One Hemlet, Sector-104, Noida, Uttar Pradesh has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 12/22, U/s 406/409/420/120B IPC, P.S.: Economic Offences Wing, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Yuvraj Sharma cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Yuvraj Sharma has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Yuvraj Sharma accused of offence in case FIR No. 12/22, U/s 406/409/420/120B IPC, P.S.: Economic Offences Wing, New Delhi and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 12.10.2026.

By Order
Ms. Niharika Kumar Sharma
Chief Judicial Magistrate (South)
Room No. 216, Saket Courts, Delhi

DP/12160/EOW/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. & 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) Dil Mohammad, S/o: Md. Kabir R/o: H.No. B-239, JJ Colony Bawana, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in E-FIR No. 30923/2022, U/s: 411/34 IPC, PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) Dil Mohammad, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) Dil Mohammad, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) Dil Mohammad, of E-FIR No. 30923/2022, U/s: 411/34 IPC, PS: Narela Industrial Area, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.10.2026.

By Order
Sahil Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North Court No. 06 1st Floor Rohini Court, Delhi
DP/11967/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Ramesh Kumar Maurya, S/o Durga Dass Maurya, R/o A98, Inder Enclave Part-I, Kirari, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 294/2017, U/s 14(1) Child Labour Act, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Ramesh Kumar Maurya cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Ramesh Kumar Maurya has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Ramesh Kumar Maurya accused of FIR No. 294/2017, U/s 14(1) Child Labour Act, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 07.10.2026.

By Order - Ms. Jasjeet Kaur
Additional Session Judge-04 (POCSO)
North-West, Room No. 203
DP/11990/RD/2026 2nd Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Corporate Office : Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra- 400 028

POSSESSION NOTICE (As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon. The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Loan Account No./Branch	Brief details of secured assets	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1.	Balchand Balchand/ Virmlesh/ Sanjay/ Kamlesh/ DEL-NHL-000626/ Delhi	All That Piece And Parcel Of Residential House No.10 Area Measuring 118.22 Sq. Yds., i.e. 98.84 Sq.mtrs. Situated At Village Pabla Begumbad, Tehsil & District Baghatp. Boundaries - East- House Of Subhash., West- Rasta 15 Ft. Wide., North- House Of Suraj., South- House Of Sanjay.	22-May-2026/ Rs. 10,25,254/- Rupees Ten Lakh Twenty Five Thousand Two Hundred Fifty Four Only.	31/08/2026

Date: September 01 2026
Place: Baghatp

Sd/- Authorized Officer,
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

“AS A NATION, WE NEED PEOPLE TO VISIT OUR COUNTRY; WE NEED TOURISM. WE DON’T WANT TO BE KNOWN MERELY AS A COUNTRY THAT IS FULL OF DISASTERS OR CONSTANTLY FACING HARDSHIP”



MANISHA URGES GLOBAL COMMUNITY TO SUPPORT FLOOD-HIT NEPAL



The ‘Dil Se...’ actress says tourism is Nepal’s lifeblood

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 31

Bollywood actress Manisha Koirala has urged the global community to come together and support Nepal following the deadly flash floods on August 26 on the Nepal-Tibet border caused by a glacier collapse. The devastating flood has killed more than 900 people, with thousands still missing.

Fighting back tears, the ‘Khamoshi’ actress called India, China and Nepal to work together to tackle global warming and prevent such deadly disasters in the future. “Global warming is real. This is not just some distant issue. I request that we, as human beings and great neighbours, China, India and Nepal some-

how join hands in this and do something collectively. We are so interconnected and so we must work together to try to prevent disasters like this,” she said at Sadhguru’s ‘In Solidarity with Nepal’ event in Kathmandu on Sunday. “I hope and pray that we become better people and that we help others just as we ourselves would want to be helped,” Manisha added.

The ‘1942: A Love Story’ actress also appealed to the international community to support Nepal’s tourism industry, especially at a time when the country is facing one of its worst challenges. Calling tourism Nepal’s ‘lifeblood’, she praised the beauty of her country and how Nepal shouldn’t be known as a country that’s ‘full of disasters’. “Beyond this, I want

to request the entire international community: you have been so kind and loving toward Nepal time and time again. I pray that your love and support continue. As a nation, we need people to visit our country; we need tourism. We don’t want to be known merely as a country that is full of disasters or constantly facing hardship. We want to be known for our beautiful weather, Himalayas, great people, nature, culture and traditions. Yes, there is a calamity near the Nepal border, but tourism is our lifeblood. I hope and encourage the international community to travel to Nepal once again,” Manisha said.

Manisha belongs to a politically influential family in Nepal. Her grandfather, Bishweshwar Prasad Koirala,

was the PM of Nepal, as were two of her great-uncles, Girija Prasad Koirala and Matrika Prasad Koirala.

Meanwhile, several Bollywood celebrities have come out in support of Nepal. Like always, actor Sonu Sood has offered to help the affected families of flood-hit Nepal with food, shelter and other assistance. Bhumi Pednekar, who also went to Assam when the state was battling a devastating flood situation a month back, wrote on social media, “Nepal, you are not alone. We are coming with food, shelter and the strength to help you rebuild.”

Also, two Mumbai-based actors, Ankur Ratan and Manasi Parek, had a close escape from Nepal while travelling for the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra.

Suniel slams Bollywood’s hypermasculine violence

Suniel Shetty, who turned 65 this month, offered a candid look at how his mindset around work and identity has shifted over the decades. In a heartfelt ‘LinkedIn’ note, the actor spoke about moving away from chasing financial milestones toward a more grounded, purpose-driven phase of both his career and personal life.

Shetty spoke at length about the importance of accepting age-appropriate roles, calling it central to his continued relevance in the industry. “Accepting roles which were age-appropriate is the only reason I’ve landed myself into this position, because there’s no point competing with kids half your age who are better looking, better built and masters of their craft,” he said.

He also addressed how he approaches ageing itself, framing it as a natural process rather than something to resist entirely. “I’m consistently working on myself, so I wouldn’t say it’s anti-ageing, but I’ve delayed the process of ageing and it’s nothing to be shy about. Wrinkles will always be there and that is a part of my life now.” AGENCIES



‘BLOOD AND GORE ARE THINGS I DON’T LIKE ABOUT FILMS TODAY,’ SAYS THE ACTOR

Big star projects don’t speak to me: Sudip Sharma

MUMBAI: Filmmaker-writer Sudip Sharma, who has contributed as a writer to films such as ‘NH10’ and ‘Udta Punjab’, said he has no immediate plans to direct a feature film for the big screen as he finds himself more drawn to the long-form series format.

Sharma most recently contributed as a writer on Anurag Kashyap’s movie ‘Bandar’.

“I don’t know what kind of film to direct right now. There is a lot of churn that is happening and the kind of films that are mostly getting made are not the kind of films that inherently interest me,” the writer-director told PTI in an interview. PTI



‘Corporates are scared to experiment’

In a podcast, Adnan Sami exposed the forced reality of Bollywood remixes

Adnan Sami slammed the increasingly convenient industry practice of churning out remixes from past hit songs. The composer-singer argued that while music companies conveniently blame the trend on the audience, the truth is that listeners are starved for original content, yet the stakeholders aren’t meeting those needs these days.

He claimed that while he doesn’t mind remixing old songs, he has contention with how the ratio between originals and remixes has shifted from

HE SHARED HOW THE RATIO BETWEEN ORIGINALS AND REMIXES HAS SHIFTED FROM 80:20 TO 20:80 NOW



80:20 to 20:80 now. “The corporates are scared to experiment. It’s happening even in cinemas.

Remakes are attempted and sequels are made;

even prequels are planned! Offshoots are also working,” Sami said on the ‘Game Changers’ podcast.

Sami quoted the example of ‘Batman’ films. Once ‘DC’ hit a saturation point making ‘Batman’ movies over decades, it decided to make a franchise out of a spin-off. Hence came Todd Phillips’ 2019 psychological thriller ‘Joker’. The Joaquin Phoenix-starrer was a spin-off of Batman’s arch-nemesis. It was followed by a sequel, ‘Joker: Folie à Deux’, a couple of years ago, which didn’t yield desired results. AGENCIES

‘I WAS CAST AS MARY JANE FOR SPIDER-MAN’

Shailene Woodley remembered how her dream role was cut from ‘The Amazing Spider-Man 2’

LOS ANGELES: Shailene Woodley said she once starred as Mary Jane Watson in The Amazing Spider-Man 2 only for the role to be cut from the final movie, which featured Andrew Garfield as the web-casting superhero.

Speaking with the SAG-AFTRA Foundation’s ‘Conversations’, ‘The Fault in Our Stars’ star said she didn’t find out about her scenes being deleted until about a year after she had finished filming for the ‘Sony Pictures’ movie, which was released in theatres in May 2014.

“I was cast as Mary Jane for Spider-Man, which was my dream. Oh my god, Spider-Man’s my favourite superhero; Mary Jane was my favourite character growing



up. So, when I got it, I was like, ‘This is so exciting!’ We filmed three scenes together, Andrew Garfield and me. And then, like a year later, they were like, ‘So, you’re not in the movie anymore’. And I was like, ‘What? What do you mean?’ And they’re like, ‘We’ve introduced a lot of

SHE DIDN’T FIND OUT ABOUT HER SCENES BEING DELETED UNTIL ABOUT A YEAR AFTER SHE HAD FINISHED FILMING FOR THE MOVIE

new characters in this last one and we’re going to wait for whatever happens between (Emma Stone) and Andrew (Garfield).”

According to her, the plan was to introduce her character after Gwen Stacy dies in the movie, but then the studio decided not to go ahead with the third instalment after the second movie didn’t do well at the box office. PTI

